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CJP claims Delhi Police withdrew security checks at the protest site



NATION: Pg 6

MP Chief Secretary Anurag Jain elevated as NITI Aayog CEO



SPORT: Pg 11

Mirabai, Lovlina lead India at CWG

Protesting students not terrorists; 152 paper leaks in last decade, says Rahul

AAISHA SABIR



NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday accused the Modi government of destroying India's education system and expressed full support for the protesting students, saying their demands, including Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, are fully legitimate and non-negotiable.

The protesting students are not terrorists and are simply asking for an education system that works and is fair, said Gandhi. Addressing a press conference at the AICC headquarters here, Gandhi alleged that the education system is not only rigged, but it is also unaffordable.

A video of alleged "police brutality" against students during Monday's 'Sansad Chalo' protest was screened at the start of the press conference. Referring to the police action, Gandhi said, "The question is why is this happening to our students."

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WANGCHUK ALSO SOUGHT PARLIAMENTARY DISCUSSION

Wangchuk: Will end fast if Centre assures no action against protesters

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Activist Sonam Wangchuk said he is ready to end his hunger strike if the government assured him that no legal action would be taken against the young protesters demanding accountability over the NEET paper leak. In the absence of such an assurance, he stressed he would be forced to continue his fast indefinitely.

"I respectfully request an unequivocal assurance from the government that none of the young protesters will face any punitive or retaliatory legal action for participating in the movement," he said in a letter to Union ministers JP Nadda and Jitendra Singh. Wangchuk further said the protesters were only raising their voices for a fair and accountable education system.

The 59-year-old activist was



Sonam Wangchuk speaks in a video message Hospital

KEY POINTS

- » Wangchuk wrote to Union ministers JP Nadda and Jitendra Singh seeking assurance
- » He said protesting students only demanded a fair, accountable education system
- » Ministers reportedly assured consideration of Wangchuk's two other key demands



- » Demands include compensation for families of students who died by suicide after NEET leak

» AROUND 65 MPs URGED WANGCHUK TO END HIS HUNGER STRIKE

removed by the police from the Jantar Mantar protest site on Saturday after three weeks of hunger strike as part of the satirical political movement Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)'s

protest against Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. But he refused to end his fast.

Amid Wangchuk's observation, protesting students continued to

head to Jantar Mantar and their numbers swelled as the day progressed. Also, the CJP has made it clear that it would meet the Centre's representatives

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Delhi Police personnel on duty at Jantar Mantar to wear uniform

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has ordered all personnel posted at Jantar Mantar to remain in uniform while on duty, after footage of plainclothes officers wielding fibre canes spread across social media and triggered public anger. Senior officers reportedly passed on the verbal directive to staff on Wednesday evening, telling them uniforms were mandatory at the protest site going forward.

The order follows Monday's crackdown, where clips showed men without uniforms or name badges

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CJP seeks talks at neutral venue as thousands continue Jantar Mantar sit-in

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Defying heavy rain, heightened security and a police crackdown earlier this week, thousands of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) supporters continued their sit-in at Jantar Mantar on Wednesday, keeping the month-long agitation over alleged examination irregularities alive. As the protest entered its second month, the CJP

declared it was open to talks with the Centre but made it clear that any dialogue must be held at Jantar Mantar or another neutral venue and should lead to concrete action on its demands.

Addressing a press briefing at the protest site, CJP chief spokesperson Saurav Das said Delhi Police informed the party on Wednesday morning that Union Health Minister J P Nadda had invited CJP

representatives to his residence for discussions. However, the party declined the invitation.

"We refused to go to anyone's house or office. The people's court is here. Ministers should come among the people," Das said. He added that if security concerns prevented a meeting at Jantar Mantar, the party was "willing to meet at a neutral location nearby".

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ALLEGATIONS OF POLICE BRUTALITY

SC declines urgent hearing; HC orders authorities to preserve CCTV footage

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Wednesday turned down a plea for urgent listing over police action against student protesters in Delhi, even as the Delhi High Court, hearing a related matter the same day, asked the Centre and city police

Don't have time to watch videos: CJI on plea against crackdown on CJP protesters

to respond and preserve all evidence, including CCTV footage.

At the Supreme Court, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, sitting with Justices Jyotsna Singh and V Mohana, refused to entertain video evidence at the mentioning stage. When a lawyer said he had footage of police brutality and asked for the matter to be listed the next day, the

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Cop on Amarnath Yatra duty killed in terrorist attack

MPOST BUREAU

SRINAGAR: A policeman deployed on Amarnath Yatra security was shot dead by a lone terrorist in South Kashmir's Anantnag on Wednesday, marking the first terror attack targeting police personnel in the Kashmir Valley this year. The attack took place around 12.30 pm at Lal Chowk in Anantnag, where Head Constable Ashiq Hussain Qureshi was on duty.

Officials said the attacker, believed to be a Pakistani terrorist, opened fire on Qureshi while he was making purchases at a nearby shop. Qureshi, a resident of Beerwah in central Kashmir and a member of the Jammu and Kashmir Police's 3rd Battalion, was critically injured and rushed to Government Medical College Hospital in Anantnag, where doctors declared him dead on arrival.

According to officials, the shopkeeper had noticed the unidentified man standing outside the shop for some time with an assault

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RAISES SEAFARER SAFETY WITH RUSSIA

Jaishankar tells China border peace key to normal relations

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar held separate talks with his Chinese counterpart Wang Yi and Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov in Manila on Wednesday, using the meetings to raise India's key strategic concerns. In discussions with China, Jaishankar said peace and tranquillity along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) remained the foundation for normal bilateral ties and also flagged concerns over trade imbalance, market access and supply chain predictability. In his meeting with Lavrov, he conveyed India's strong concern over the safety of Indian seafarers in the Black Sea following the killing of four Indian crew members in a Russian attack on a merchant vessel off Ukraine's coast. The meetings took place on the sidelines of high-level engagements under the Association of Southeast



Union External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar meets Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, in Manila, Philippines

Asian Nations (ASEAN). Opening his meeting with Wang, Jaishankar said India and China should continue building a stable and cooperative relationship based on "mutual respect, mutual interest and mutual sensitivity."

He said peace along the border remained essential for improving bilateral relations. "Peace and tranquillity in the border areas is obviously the pre-requisite for normal

ties. Since October 2024, both sides have engaged to ensure that important objective," Jaishankar said.

He added that sustained attention was needed to maintain progress and that the existing mechanisms dealing with border issues should receive continued support.

Jaishankar also said it was natural for two neighbouring countries of India's and China's size to

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Assam flood: 31 dead so far, 5.65 lakh affected

GUWAHATI: Assam's flood crisis deepened Wednesday as 21 more deaths pushed the season's toll to 31, with nearly 5.65 lakh people now affected across twelve districts. Sivasaagar remains worst hit, with 13 deaths and 3.6 lakh people affected, followed by Jorhat and Charaideo. Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma toured affected areas and announced Rs 4 lakh compensation for each victim's family. He acknowledged relief gaps, saying, "There is no road or any mode of communication to reach out to those people who are still in their homes."

Authorities run 273 relief camps housing 12,284 people. Over 6,000 have been rescued so far. The IMD has issued a yellow alert, forecasting more rain over the next four days.

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MOVE MAY IMPACT INDIA

Trump announces up to 200% tariffs on generic medicines

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: US President Donald Trump has laid out a plan to bring generic drug manufacturing back to the United States, a move that could hit India hard since it is the biggest supplier of generic medicines to the American market.

In a post on Truth Social on Wednesday, Trump said the zero per cent tariff currently in place on generic drugs will stay for two years starting August 1. After that, the rate will jump to 100 per cent for a year, then climb to 200 per cent from then on.

"This is done to RESHORE Generic Pharmaceutical Production into America, with a penalty to those Companies that decide not to build Plant

KEY POINTS

- » Zero per cent tariff on generics continues for two years from August 1
- » Tariff rises to 100 per cent for one year after that period
- » Rate then climbs permanently to 200 per cent from 2029 onward
- » Move penalizes firms that don't build US plants within given time



» Patented and branded drug tariff policy remains unchanged, Trump confirms

and Equipment within the stated period of time given to them," Trump wrote. He said the goal was to protect American citizens, and added that the existing policy on patented and branded drugs

would not change. India is often called the pharmacy of the world because it ships generic medicines to countries everywhere. In 2025 alone, India sent USD 9.7 billion worth

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JANTAR MANTAR PROTEST SEES VOLUNTEERS MANAGE SECURITY

CJP claims Delhi Police withdrew security checks at the protest site

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The atmosphere at the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) protest site at Jantar Mantar has changed noticeably since the July 20 "Sansad Chalo" march. While thousands of supporters continue to gather at the venue every day, the security arrangements inside the protest site are markedly different from what they were before the march.

Before the July 20 march, Delhi Police had installed baggage-scanning machines at the entry points to the protest site, which is now missing. Every visitor entering Jantar Mantar underwent security screening, and police personnel affixed stickers on checked bags to indicate they had been cleared.

However, following the police action during the July 20 march, those arrangements are no longer visible. No baggage-scanning machines were seen at the entry points and no police personnel were present to conduct security checks, despite a steady flow of supporters arriving at the protest site. Instead, CJP volunteers were regulating entry and managing the movement of people inside the venue.

Highlighting the change, the CJP posted on social media, "Where is the Delhi Police now? Crowd is constantly



'While add'l CRPF and Rapid Action Force have been deployed around key government installations, volunteers at Jantar Mantar were seen handling entry and maintaining order'

increasing but there is no police present for checking. As thousands stream into Jantar Mantar, Delhi Police has abandoned all security duties. Student volunteers are running checks at the front gate while the baggage-scanning machine at the back gate has been quietly removed.

Stone-pelting, baton charge mark fresh clashes

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Violence erupted again near Jantar Mantar and Tolstoy Marg on Wednesday as a pro-CJP rally turned violent, with protesters clashing with police and pelting stones. Security forces resorted to a baton charge and fired tear gas shells to bring the situation under control.

Delhi Police said more than 20 personnel, including Additional Commissioner of Police Jaiprakash of the Punjabi Bagh area, were injured in the clashes. Several protesters also sustained injuries.

More than 50 protesters were detained from the spot, and police have launched an investigation into the incident. According to police, extensive security arrangements, including barricades, frisking points and heavy deployment of personnel,

had been put in place around Jantar Mantar and adjoining areas. Despite these measures, a large number of protesters gathered on Tolstoy Marg on Wednesday evening.

Police said that while protesters were raising slogans, the situation escalated after some demonstrators allegedly began pelting stones at police personnel and members of the Rapid Action Force (RAF). Some protesters were also allegedly carrying sticks, which were used to assault police and security personnel.

Police said they repeatedly appealed to protesters to remain peaceful and disperse, stressing that they had no interest in confrontation. However, as the violence intensified, security forces resorted to a baton charge and tear gas to disperse the crowd.

Several government

vehicles were also damaged during the violence.

ACP Connaught Place Vivek Bhagat sustained a head injury while overseeing the law and order situation and was rushed to hospital. Sources said he is recovering well.

Police are examining CCTV footage, drone footage and videos circulating on social media to identify those involved in the violence and stone-pelting. They said legal action would be taken against those responsible for attacking police personnel and damaging property, with cases to be registered under the relevant provisions of law.

Delhi Police, the RAF and additional security forces remained on high alert in the Jantar Mantar and Tolstoy Marg areas until late on Wednesday night.

assisting protesters and maintaining order within the demonstration area. The CJP's sit-in over alleged examination irregularities has continued into its second month, with fresh supporters continuing to join the agitation even after the police action earlier this week.

Cops reject brutality claims

Police release counter-video claiming attacks by protesters as demonstrators demand action over misconduct

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A series of videos circulating on social media alleging police brutality and misconduct by Delhi Police during a recent protest by supporters of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) has sparked widespread controversy. Delhi Police has rejected allegations that it used excessive force against protesters.

The videos, which have gone viral in recent days, appear to show clashes between protesters and police, with several social media users alleging that officers used disproportionate force, including against women demonstrators.

One video is captioned, "Women Are Safe?", along with a reference to the Jantar Mantar protest site and the date of the demonstration. Another carries a Hindi caption accusing the police of "goonda-giri" (thuggery). One of the videos also contains allegations that a police personnel sexually harassed a female protester during the demonstration. Delhi Police, however, said it was unaware of any such video or incident and denied knowledge of the allegation.

The controversy intensified after Delhi Police responded to the viral videos by alleging that protesters had made false accusations. Police said it would pursue legal action over the alleged misinformation, shifting the focus from the original claims to the conduct of the protesters.



To support its position, Delhi Police released its own video, which it said showed protesters attacking police personnel during the demonstration. The force has cited the footage while defending its actions and accusing protesters of levelling false allegations. However, the police video has itself drawn criticism on social media, with users arguing that it also appears to show officers using excessive force. Competing videos from both sides have fuelled conflicting narratives online, prompting debate over what transpired during the protest.

The circulation of multiple videos has also led to speculation over which footage is authentic, whether the clips present the full sequence of events, and when they were recorded and shared.

None of the allegations could be independently verified. No FIR or police complaint has been registered so far in connection with either the alleged sexual harassment or the alleged false accusations made by protesters or police.

The incident has reignited debate on women's safety, policing and the handling of protests across Indian social media. Many users have criticised Delhi Police's response, arguing that it did not adequately address the seriousness of the sexual harassment allegations.

Some protesters have also accused the police of using its video to justify a crackdown on demonstrators while avoiding a direct response to the allegations of sexual misconduct. Others have alleged that the force is attempting to cover up police misconduct. Delhi Police has not announced any internal inquiry into the sexual harassment allegations or identified any police personnel in connection with the purported incident.

Protesters have demanded that police register a comprehensive FIR and investigate their allegations promptly. For now, the competing claims continue to dominate social media, with both sides accusing each other of spreading false narratives.

Delhi Univ admits 63,756 students after UG Round 1

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi University has completed the first round of undergraduate admissions under the Common Seat Allocation System (CSAS), with a total of 63,756 candidates securing admissions, according to official data.

Of the admitted candidates, 15,265 have opted to freeze their allotted seats while 48,153 have chosen the upgrade option to be considered for a higher-preference programme or college in the subsequent rounds.

The latest admission figures indicate an increase from the data released on July 21, when the university had reported that 61,932 candidates had confirmed their admissions after paying the requisite fees ahead of the round one payment deadline.

Earlier, over 81,900 candidates had accepted the undergraduate seats allotted to them in the first round, reflecting strong participation in the admission process.

The first allocation list, announced last week, had offered seats to 93,033 candidates against more than 71,000 undergraduate seats across 221 programmes in 67 colleges for the 2026-27 academic session.

The allocations were made from among more than 2.08 lakh candidates who completed Phase II of the admission process by submitting their programme and college preferences. Candidates choosing upgrades will be considered in the next round, while frozen seats remain unchanged. The second list is due July 25.

MHA orders deployment of 20 add'l CRPF companies in Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre has ordered deployment of 20 additional companies of the CRPF in Delhi to strengthen security measures in view of the CJP protests and demonstrations by various political parties, officials said on Wednesday.

The forces, all drawn from the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), are being airlifted from West Bengal after the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) ordered their immediate deployment in the national capital on Tuesday night.

A total of 20 CRPF companies are being airlifted from Kolkata to be deployed in Delhi to strengthen the law and order in view of the CJP protests, demonstrations by various



political parties and the ongoing Parliament session, official sources in the security establishment said.

Multiple instances of violent clashes during the latest protests have necessitated this immediate deployment, they said.

They said these companies were deployed in West Bengal for the conduct of assembly elections held there a few months back and were asked to stay put on the request of

the state government, they said. A CRPF company has a strength of about 100 personnel.

About 30 companies of the CRPF and its specialised anti-riots unit Rapid Action Force (RAF) have been provided by the Centre to the Delhi Police to beef up security measures in view of the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) protest and the Monsoon session of the Parliament that began on July 20, according to the officials.

Delhi moves to align police, revenue jurisdictions

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is preparing to propose a major administrative restructuring to the Centre by aligning police jurisdictions with the Capital's newly created revenue districts, a move aimed at improving governance and public service delivery.

According to government officials, discussions are underway to expand Delhi's existing 11 police districts to 13 so that their boundaries correspond with the 13 revenue districts notified by the Delhi government last year. Since policing in Delhi comes under the Union Ministry of Home Affairs, any such reorganisation will require the Centre's approval.

An official said the proposal

Since policing in Delhi comes under Union Ministry of Home Affairs, any reorganisation will require the Central govt's approval

is intended to eliminate overlaps between police and civil administration, enabling better coordination in law enforcement, disaster management, land administration and delivery of citizen services.

The development comes after the Centre amended the Fourteenth Schedule of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 1957, to bring the names of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) zones in line with the revised revenue district nomenclature.

The amendment, notified by the Union Ministry of

Home Affairs, updates the official list of all 250 MCD wards and the municipal zones under which they fall. Officials said the change establishes uniform administrative terminology across civic and revenue departments, making governance more streamlined.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta welcomed the amendment, saying it would strengthen coordination between the Revenue Department and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi.

She said adopting a common nomenclature for administrative areas would

improve coordination among government departments, facilitate smoother implementation of welfare and development schemes, and make it easier for residents to access public services.

Gupta added that the initiative reflects the Centre's emphasis on technology-driven governance, administrative efficiency and citizen-centric reforms.

The Delhi government had, in December last year, notified a new administrative framework by creating 13 revenue districts and 39 sub-divisions (tehsils). The restructuring aligns revenue, municipal and proposed police jurisdictions to improve coordination, simplify administration and speed up grievance redressal, subject to the Centre's approval.

struction of the joint PWD-DMRC double-decker flyover project at Karawal Nagar, Ghonda and Brijpuri Junction- Mangal Pandey Marg in northeast Delhi is progressing at a fast pace," it said. The entire project is being executed by the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC). A Memorandum of Understanding between the Public Works Department (PWD) and DMRC was signed on February 24, 2021. The project was originally approved at a



someone fainted or complained of breathlessness.

Among them are volunteers from the Five Rivers Heart Association, an NGO associated with US-based doctor Swaiman Singh, whose teams provided medical assistance also during the 2021 farmers' protest. Amritpal Singh, a volunteer with the organisation,

said the team decided to reach Jantar Mantar along with an ambulance after seeing videos and accounts of injuries during Monday's clashes.

"The NEET examination is the baseline for every doctor in this country. The quality of medical education affects every citizen because every patient eventually places their life in a doctor's hands. As doctors ourselves, we understand what these students are fighting for and why this matters," he said.

"A team of about 50 doctors -- including cardiologists, dermatologists, orthopaedics and general surgeons -- is serving in Delhi, along with nursing staff, pharmacists and many more volunteers on rotation for the humanitarian cause," president and founder Dr

Swaiman Singh said.

Volunteer Amritpal said they first reached the protest site on the day of the march and have remained there since, attending to protesters with cuts, bruises, swollen limbs, dehydration, fever and breathing difficulties.

"Many people are still coming with injuries from the march. Others have developed fever after remaining outdoors in the monsoon. Some experience breathlessness because of exhaustion. We are trying to treat whoever comes to us," Singh said.

Volunteer doctors continued treating protesters at Jantar Mantar, providing first aid, medicines and emergency care as crowds grew and demonstrations continued.



The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) has installed a 58-metre steel span across NH-9 and the Delhi-Meerut Expressway near Noida Electronic City station without disrupting traffic, marking a major engineering milestone. The span forms part of a new Blue Line reversal facility. Installed 14 metres above the carriageway over two days, it is the first Delhi Metro viaduct to cross an operational expressway, with work continuing on a second span. Civil works are expected to be completed by the end of the year

MPOST

Delhi govt cuts processing time for 84 online services

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has reduced the processing time for 84 services available through its Single Window System, with some services now being delivered instantly, as part of its deregulation and digital governance initiative, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced on Tuesday.

The move follows a comprehensive review conducted by the Information Technology Department under Deregulation Exercise - Phase II, which assessed the delivery timeline of 95 key services across 18 government departments.

According to the government, the Single Window System is an online platform that enables citizens and businesses to apply for licences, permits, approvals and clearances through a single portal.

Highlighting the objective behind the exercise, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said, "The Delhi Government is committed to making government services faster, simpler and more transparent for citizens and businesses." The review identified opportunities to streamline procedures, reducing processing time for 84 services, with some now delivered instantly. Gupta said the reforms would improve ease of doing business, strengthen digital governance, enhance transparency, simplify procedures and make public services faster.

MPOST

16 STATIONS SHUT FOR 8 HOURS

The day Metro paused Capital



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Thousands of office-goers, students and other commuters were stranded as 16 Delhi Metro stations remained closed for around eight hours on Wednesday due to security reasons amid the ongoing Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest at Jantar Mantar.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) had shut the 16 stations in the morning and added Jhandewalan to the list in the afternoon. The exit gates of the stations were opened in the evening.

The closures came amid the ongoing CJP protest that saw greater participation on Wednesday in comparison to Tuesday. Opposition leaders slammed the BJP-led government, saying it should have addressed the students instead of closing metro stations.

For many commuters, it was the second major disruption within a week after a similar shutdown on Monday. Passengers said trains continued to run on several stretches but skipped the closed stations, forcing them to travel beyond their destinations and retrace their journey by road. Vrinda, a commuter travelling through Central Secretariat, said the protesters had gathered near the station premises, leading to confusion among passengers. There was also a surge in online cab booking.

CROWD GROWS

NEW DELHI: The chants grew louder and the crowd thicker at Jantar Mantar on Wednesday as fresh groups of protesters from across the country poured into the protest site, many after overnight journeys by bus and train.

Two days after the 'Chalo Sansad' march, the sit-in continued to draw new participants, many walking into the protest site with backpacks and rolled-up banners after travelling through the night. Volunteers directed them towards seating areas and distributed drinking water and food packets as more groups joined the gathering.

Children in school uniforms stood shoulder to shoulder with college students, office-goers and elderly protesters. Some sat on the road listening to speeches from the stage, while others gathered near the police barricades, raising slogans and holding placards above their heads.

MPPOST

About 15 fake social media posts rebutted since protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has rebutted at least 15 instances of alleged fake news and misleading social media posts since the Monday protest here, while its fact-check teams are analysing hundreds of viral videos and posts to trace their origin and identify those spreading misinformation, police sources said on Wednesday.

The rebuttals included claims that a 12-year-old girl and a woman protester were assaulted by police, that CJP

founder Abhijit Dipke had been detained, that a girl had died in a stampede following a police lathicharge, and that police personnel used pellet guns or batons fitted with nails during the clashes.

Police and protesters led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) have blamed each other for the violence during the march to Parliament on the NEET issue.

Delhi Police has faced criticism and charges of brutality with dozens of videos on social media purportedly showing clashes between the police

personnel and protesters, amid lathicharge, tear gas use and stone pelting. According to an internal compilation prepared by the police, several claims circulating on social media since Monday were found to be false, misleading, old or shared out of context, prompting the force to issue rebuttals through its official social media handles. Police denied claims that videos purportedly showing attacks on women or violence by police were from the protest site, saying many of them were either unrelated to the protests or circulated with misleading context.

A police source said investigators were also examining a viral audio clip in which the voice of a senior police officer was allegedly altered. "The original appeal by the officer asking protesters to maintain peace and law and order was manipulated. Pakistan-based handlers allegedly modulated the voice and inserted fabricated audio. The viral clip is completely fake and has already been rebutted," the source said.

The source said Delhi Police has constituted a dedicated fact-

check team that is scrutinising every viral video, photograph and audio clip related to the protest. "The team verifies the source of every video, examines it from all possible angles, checks available databases and analyses digital footprints. Whenever a claim is found to be false or misleading, an official clarification is issued through the Delhi Police's official X handle," the source said. Police said investigators were simultaneously analysing social media posts and videos showing attacks on police person-

nel, stone-pelting, vandalism of police vehicles and damage to public property during the protest. These videos are being matched with CCTV footage, AI-based camera inputs and other digital evidence to identify those allegedly involved in the violence and support the ongoing investigation.

Officials said legal action would be initiated against those found deliberately creating, altering or circulating false information aimed at spreading panic, misleading the public or disrupting law and order.

Police tap AI, file 10 FIRs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police is using its network of artificial intelligence-based cameras to identify people allegedly involved in clashes during the CJP protest, with investigators saying those responsible for attacking police personnel would be arrested, sources said on Wednesday.

The AI-enabled surveillance system is being used to analyse footage from the extensive network of CCTV cameras

installed across the New Delhi district, a police source said.

"These AI cameras will help police identify those who were involved in clashes with the police, damaging government vehicles and attacking police personnel. Their criminal records will be checked using the police database and they will be arrested," the source said.

The source said people who did not participate in any violence had nothing to worry about. Appealing to the public to assist the investigation,

the source said citizens could share information about those involved in the violence, and their identity will never be disclosed. "There is a sea of CCTV cameras installed in New Delhi. Every person found to be involved in the clashes will be identified, their criminal records will be verified and they will be brought to justice," another police officer said, requesting anonymity. So far, 10 FIRs have been registered in connection with the violence, the police said.

VOLUNTEERS KEEP PROTESTERS FED, HYDRATED

Pizza, biryani... & protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A steady supply of pizzas, biryani, langar, fruits and even golgappas have turned into protest essentials at the Jantar Mantar, where volunteers from different walks of life have joined hands to keep hundreds of students participating in the ongoing CJP protest fed and hydrated.

As the protest demanding accountability over the NEET paper 'leak' and resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan continued, Jantar Mantar has transformed into

a community kitchen, with office-goers, elderly citizens, children and community groups standing shoulder to shoulder, serving meals, snacks and refreshments to the agitators.

The menu also reflects the preferences of the largely young crowd - pizzas, biryani, chips, biscuits, fruit juices and cold drinks - while local vendors are offering golgappas and dahi bhallas to the protesters - all free of cost.

Many food packets also carried portable hand fans to help the protesters keep cool amid the humid weather.

The Sikh community, including Nihang Sikhs, who had joined the protest on Tuesday, organised a langar that continued through Wednesday, serving fresh meals to anyone walking in.

Many children were spotted distributing water bottles, while the elderly volunteers handed out bananas and seasonal fruits to the gathering.

Ravi Maurya, an employee with a multinational company in Delhi who took leave from work to volunteer, said support was arriving from across the country and even overseas.

BJP attacks Cong protest

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra on Tuesday strongly criticised the Congress party for staging a protest outside Prime Minister Narendra Modi's official residence, calling it "highly condemnable" and "an insult to democracy."

In a statement, Malhotra alleged that the protests and unrest witnessed over the past three days were not a genuine student movement but were politically motivated.

"The chaos witnessed over the past three days is not a student movement. In reality, it is the unfortunate outcome of ongoing attempts by the Congress, Aam Aadmi Party, Communists and Samajwadi Party to incite a youth movement," he said. Malhotra asserted that the Prime Minister's Office symbolises the dignity of the nation and said protesting outside the Prime Minister's residence amounted to disrespecting not only the office but also the people of India.

"The office of the Prime Minister represents the honour of 1.4 billion Indians. By surrounding and protesting at the Prime Minister's residence, the Congress has insulted not just the Prime Minister, but the people of the country as well," he said.



From few to many

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: What began as a protest by a handful of competitive exam aspirants at Jantar Mantar has transformed into a larger student movement, with participation swelling significantly after allegations of police brutality against demonstrators. Many students who had never intended to protest say they were compelled to join after witnessing the crackdown.

Among them is Aryan Dubey, a law student at National Law University, Delhi, who believes the movement reflects years of accumulated frustration over alleged irregularities in competitive examinations, including the NEET and SSC paper leaks, and what protesters describe as a lack of accountability in the examination system.

"This is not just about one exam anymore," Dubey said. "Students have been carrying resentment for years. The police action became the immediate trigger that united people from different campuses and

backgrounds." Drawing from sociological theories of collective action, Dubey argued that protests often evolve through stages from discussion and shared resentment to leadership and finally a triggering event that transforms isolated grievances into a mass movement. According to him, the alleged detention of protest leaders and the police response accelerated that process.

Another protester, Pallavi, a NEET aspirant, said she joined the demonstration out of solidarity with fellow students. Recalling the police action, she alleged that protesters, including women, children and elderly participants, were subjected to force. "We were unarmed. People were scared and running for safety. After that day, many of us couldn't sleep or return to our normal routines," she said, adding that the experience had left many students traumatised.

Despite the events, Pallavi described the atmosphere inside the protest site as peaceful and supportive.



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GOVT ANNOUNCES RS 4 LAKH EX GRATIA

Heavy rain aggravates Assam’s flood situation, 31 people dead so far

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GUWAHATI: Heavy rainfall battered several districts in Assam on Wednesday, aggravating the flood situation in the state that has affected 5.65 lakh people, with Sivasagar district being the worst-hit.

As many as 21 deaths were reported on Tuesday, according to the Assam State Disaster Management Authority (ASDMA). Sivasagar reported 13 fatalities, Charaideo five, Golaghat two and Jorhat one.

With these deaths, the toll in this year’s flood in the state rose to 31. One more has died in urban flooding in Guwahati. Around 70 people are missing.

Aggravating the situation, the India Meteorolog-



A woman carrying a goat crosses a flood-affected area after heavy rainfall, in Golaghat, Wednesday PTI

ical Department issued an ‘Orange Alert’ on Wednesday, asking people to be prepared for calamity, and a ‘Yellow Alert’ for the next four days as it predicted thunderstorms, lightning and heavy rains at isolated places.

The flood issue rocked the Assam Assembly with the Opposition bringing an Adjournment Motion, to which the government said the scale of the natural calamity has caught the administration off guard as these 12

Highlights

» As many as 21 deaths were reported on Tuesday, according to the Assam State Disaster Management Authority

» The flood issue rocked the Assam Assembly with the Opposition bringing an Adjournment Motion

districts had not witnessed such a deluge in over 60 years.

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma visited several flood-affected areas in Upper Assam districts, and announced an initial ex gratia of Rs 4 lakh to the kin of each

dead in the deluge. “The flood has caused extensive damage. I have assured the affected families that they are not alone in this crisis. Our government is standing with them in every step of rehabilitation and rebuilding of livelihoods,” he told reporters in Sivasagar. Over complaints that a large section of people were not receiving relief, Sarma said that there have been difficulties in providing aid in villages which are under water.

“We have not been able to reach many places as there are no roads or any mode of communication. We cannot air-drop food items as it will fall in deep waters. We are waiting for the water to recede and trying our best to reduce the people’s difficulties,” he added.

Significant step: India’s first dengue vaccine marks milestone

Experts hope for wider access and affordable pricing

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The vaccine is designed to protect against all four dengue virus serotypes and can be administered without prior dengue infection or pre-vaccination testing

Birla Hospital(R), Delhi, said the expected price of the vaccine in India is likely to be below Rs 10,000, although the final cost will be known closer to its launch.

She added that the availability of doses is yet to be confirmed, but considering the country’s large population,

efforts should ensure that the vaccine is accessible to everyone and not limited only to those who can afford it.

“We are looking forward to support from the government so that wider availability can be ensured,” she said.

Arora described the approval as an important milestone, noting that developing a vaccine capable of providing protection against all dengue infections has been extremely challenging.

She said QDENG A offers protection against all four dengue virus serotypes through two doses administered three months apart, without requiring any prior dengue infection. According to her, many households have lost young patients to dengue fever, a disease that could be better controlled if infections are prevented.

From Page 1

Wangchuk

at a neutral place and would not go to any minister’s home or office.

Wangchuk also said that Union ministers Nadda and Singh had already assured him that the government would positively consider his two other key demands.

In a letter addressed to the two ministers, Wangchuk said that Nadda and Singh, who visited him at the Medanta Hospital on Tuesday night, assured him that the government would positively consider providing adequate compensation to the families of students who died by suicide following the NEET paper ‘leak’, and holding a meaningful discussion in Parliament to ensure accountability for exam ‘irregularities’, including considering the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

“Therefore, I respectfully request an unequivocal assurance from the government that none of the young protesters will face any punitive or retaliatory legal action for participating in this movement. Their only ‘offence’ has been to raise their voice for a fair and accountable education system,” Wangchuk wrote.

Sharing the letter on X, Wangchuk said, “An appeal to the government regarding breaking my fast... Once the assurance from the government comes, I will also appeal to the peacefully protesting students to halt the movement for now and enter into dialogue with the government.”

Referring to the July 20 ‘Chalo Sansad’ march, Wangchuk said it “remained very peaceful despite the atrocities and disproportionate use of force by the police”.

“The entire nation and the world witnessed their patience and commitment to democratic protest. I sincerely hope that this faith in democratic institutions is not further undermined by any legal cases, harassment or vindictive action against those who participated,” he said. Around 65 MPs from different political parties had written to him, while several met him personally and urged him to end his fast, Wangchuk said.

“They have all urged me to end my fast, reminding me that I still have much work to do in the service of our nation. I agree with them. I want to live. I want to return to my students, to education, and to the work that has defined my life.”

“The future of our democracy depends not on how it treats those who agree with it, but on how it treats its young citizens when they dare to speak with courage, hope and conviction,” he added.

Earlier on Wednesday, a delegation of opposition MPs, including Congress’ Vivek Tankha, CPI(M)’s John Brittas and TMC’s Sagarika Ghose, met Wangchuk at the Medanta Hospital and appealed to him to end his fast.

In a letter signed by the MPs from several opposition parties, they assured him that the issues of examination reforms and accountability in the education sector would be taken up in Parliament.

NEET leak

seeking the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. “Our demand is simple. When the entire nation is feeling the pain of our students, all other business of the House should be set aside and

this burning issue should be the top priority for Parliament,” Venugopal said. SP chief Akhilesh Yadav expressed anguish that while the BJP and Congress members spoke, he was not allowed to participate. He said if the interests of youth and students are hurt, the opposition is bound to protest on the streets also.

Later, talking to reporters, Rijiju said the government is ready for a “detailed discussion”, as the people should know the steps taken by the government.

He accused the opposition of hitting the streets and not holding a debate in Parliament and said sensitive issues pertaining to the youth need discussion in Parliament. Street protests will not yield results, he underlined.

Most Congress and SP members were wearing black clothes in the House to protest the NEET paper leak and police crackdown on protesters at Jantar Mantar and other areas on Monday.

Separately, Pradhan met the Lok Sabha speaker in the Parliament House.

The opposition has been demanding a discussion on the NEET paper leak issue and is also seeking the resignation of Pradhan over the handling of the controversy over the alleged examination irregularities. Similar scenes were witnessed in the Rajya Sabha, which saw repeated adjournments after the government accused the opposition led by the Congress of bringing in new conditions to not allow a discussion on the NEET paper leak issue. Rijiju said in the Upper House that the government is ready to discuss all issues, but the chairman will decide under which rule a debate can happen.

Both DMK’s Tiruchi Siva and Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge appealed to Harivansh, who was in the chair, to allow a discussion on the NEET paper leak issue to take place under Rule 267, citing the current situation as “rarest of rare”. Amid the uproar, Hairvansh adjourned the House for the day.

Even though the government agreed to discuss the issue in Parliament, the opposition wanted the discussion to be held under Rule 267 and also laid down the condition of Pradhan’s resignation before such a debate is taken up.

Citing past rulings, Deputy Chairman Harivansh said in the last four decades, Rule 267 has been invoked in the House on the “rarest of the rare occasions”.

Rule 267 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Rajya Sabha enables a member, with the chairman’s consent, to seek suspension of a listed business of the House to take up a matter of urgent public importance.

Earlier, Leader of the House J P Nadda slammed the opposition parties, saying, “The INDI Alliance has indulged in irresponsible behaviour; they are destroying the dignity of Parliament.”

CCTVs footage

CJI told him not to waste the court’s time. “We are not interested in videos, we don’t have time to watch... We don’t want to watch videos,” the CJI said.

The plea stemmed from Monday’s march by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) to Parliament, where thousands of students had gathered demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over alleged examination irregularities. Police used batons and tear gas to hold back the crowd.

Meanwhile, the Delhi High Court took a different approach to a similar grievance. A bench led by

Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia issued notice on two petitions filed by Umesh Kumar and Anshul Kumar, directing the police, the central government and the National Human Rights Commission to file counter affidavits within four weeks. The court also ordered that all records related to the incident, including CCTV, drone and body-cam footage, be preserved under standard police procedure. The case will next be heard on September 11.

Senior lawyers representing the petitioners, including N Hariharan, Vikas Singh and Gopal Sankaranarayanan, told the court that police and the Rapid Action Force had used disproportionate force against a peaceful gathering that included women and children, leaving more than 90 students injured. Sankaranarayanan alleged that officers without name tags or uniforms were involved, naming an Additional DCP he said was seen slapping a woman on video. The lawyers called for a judicial inquiry and an independent probe, arguing water cannons, the standard first step, were never used, while tear gas was fired directly at protesters.

Additional Solicitor General S V Raju, appearing for the government, dismissed the petitions as speculative and politically motivated, arguing they relied on social media posts rather than formal complaints. He said the crowd had turned violent, injuring police personnel and damaging vehicles, and that prohibitory orders were already in force in the area at the time.

Jantar Mantar

Das maintained that CJP had always been willing to engage in dialogue, provided the talks focused on resolving the protesters’ demands rather than becoming “meaningless discussions”. He said thousands of people continued to remain at Jantar Mantar and the movement was gaining support across the country.

Reiterating the party’s demands, Das sought the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, Rs.1 crore compensation for families of students who allegedly died by suicide following the NEET paper leak controversy, withdrawal of all FIRs registered against peaceful protesters and a sovereign guarantee that no fresh FIRs or legal action would be taken against participants in the movement.

CJP spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka warned that the agitation would only intensify if the government failed to respond. Referring to the July 20 “Sansad Chalo” march, he said, “What happened on July 20 was a trailer. If the government doesn’t agree, millions more will come to Delhi.”

The latest demand comes after Delhi Police registered multiple FIRs over the violence that broke out during Monday’s march and launched an investigation into whether the clashes were part of an alleged larger conspiracy.

The protest, which began on June 20, has continued despite heavy overnight rain and a massive security deployment across the national capital. Volunteers distributed food and essential supplies to protesters as fresh supporters arrived at Jantar Mantar. Das also claimed the movement had spread to Goa, Mumbai and Jaipur, describing it as an “organic” nationwide campaign.

Meanwhile, in a significant appeal, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke urged climate activist Sonam Wangchuk to end his fast, saying the country needed him and assuring him that the campaign for examina-

tion justice would continue. “Your sacrifice has inspired a generation,” the party said in a statement, promising to carry the movement forward.

Opposition MPs, including Congress leader Vivek Tankha, Trinamool Congress MP Sagarika Ghose and CPI(M) MP John Brittas, were expected to meet Wangchuk to assure him that the issue would be raised during the Monsoon Session of Parliament.

Furthermore, security across Delhi was further tightened after the Ministry of Home Affairs ordered the deployment of 20 additional companies of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), taking the total deployment of CRPF and Rapid Action Force personnel to around 50 companies during the Parliament session. Criticising the move, Dipke questioned whether the government intended to use more force against students after the police action on July 20.

The party also alleged that its official Instagram account was briefly taken down on Wednesday before being restored within minutes. Late on Tuesday night, Dipke clarified that CJP had called for protests only at Jantar Mantar and warned that anyone gathering elsewhere in the city was not associated with the organisation. “They are not with CJP,” he said.

Delhi Police

beating protesters alongside their uniformed colleagues. In one clip, a demonstrator can be heard asking a plainclothes man, “Who are you and why are you not wearing a uniform and a name badge?” before he allegedly kept striking them. A separate video near Connaught Place appeared to show similar force being used.

TMC MP Mahua Moitra named one such man as Honey Dagar and demanded answers from police. Records suggest he is a constable with the 8th Battalion, though his present posting remains unconfirmed. Congress leader Supriya Shrinate raised concerns over treatment of women protesters. Police have not responded.

Amarnath Yatra

rifle wrapped in cloth and even asked him if he wanted to buy anything, unaware of his intentions.

The Resistance Front (TRF), considered a proxy of the Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT), claimed responsibility for the targeted killing through a social media post soon after the attack.

The incident triggered widespread anger within the police force as the area was expected to be under tight security because of the ongoing Amarnath Yatra.

Security forces immediately sealed the area and launched a large counter-terrorism operation across Anantnag, Pulwama, Shopian and Kulgam districts. Director General of Police Nalin Prabhat visited the attack site to review the situation, while mobile checkpoints were set up and extensive searches were carried out. Police also detained more than 1,000 suspected overground workers (OGWs) for questioning as senior officers personally supervised the intensified operations across the four districts.

At the Anantnag police lines, police, Army and paramilitary personnel paid floral tributes to the slain head constable. The grief was most visible at Qureshi’s final farewell as his tricolour-draped coffin was taken to his ancestral home in Budgam. His mother and brother

broke down in tears as they held on to the coffin before it was placed in the ambulance.

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah condemned the killing and said the “brave cop made the ultimate sacrifice in a cowardly terror attack”. He said such incidents would not weaken the administration’s resolve or allow terrorists to achieve their objectives.

“Today, on this occasion, when we have not even buried that brave hero yet, making any political statement standing here would be irresponsible and wrong on my part. So today, I will only offer my tributes to him; we will discuss other matters some other time,” Abdullah said.

Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha also condemned the attack and said those responsible would be brought to justice. CPI(M) leader M Y Tarigami, Peoples Conference president Sajad Gani Lone and Apni Party chief Altaf Bukhari also denounced the killing as security forces remained on high alert across the Valley.

Jaishankar tells

have differing interests, but those differences should not be allowed to develop into disputes.

“It is the responsibility of diplomacy to properly manage them,” he said. Along with security issues, Jaishankar raised India’s concerns over economic ties. He said fair market access, reducing the trade imbalance and improving predictability in supply chains remained important priorities. He also called for greater movement on official exchanges, people-to-people contacts and meetings under bilateral mechanisms. India and China have taken several steps in recent months to improve relations after the military standoff in eastern Ladakh that strained ties for more than four years.

Following military and diplomatic negotiations, both countries withdrew troops from several friction points along the LAC. In October 2024, they reached a disengagement agreement covering Depsang and Demchok, the last remaining friction points in eastern Ladakh.

Soon after that agreement, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping met in Kazan and decided on measures to improve bilateral ties. Their discussions were followed by another meeting on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Tianjin in August last year, where Modi said India remained committed to advancing relations based on mutual trust, respect and sensitivity.

Referring to these developments, Jaishankar said relations had been “gradually normalising” since the leaders’ meeting in Kazan and that the direction was reaffirmed during the Tianjin meeting.

He also welcomed recent measures, including the resumption of direct flights, changes to the visa regime, the restart of the Kailash Manasarovar Yatra and the reopening of border trade. Jaishankar also thanked China for supporting India’s initiatives during its current chairship of BRICS and said both countries should exchange views on pressing international developments.

Later in the day, Jaishankar met Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov, with the safety of Indian seafarers becoming a key issue in the talks.

The meeting came a day after India summoned Russian Charge d’Affaires Vladimir Ladanov to the Ministry of External Affairs fol-

lowing Sunday’s Russian attack on the Guinea-Bissau-flagged merchant vessel MV Golden Leo. The strike killed 10 people, including four Indian crew members, marking the first deaths of Indian seafarers linked to the Russia-Ukraine conflict.

After the meeting, Jaishankar said he had “reiterated our strong concern regarding the safety of Indian seafarers in the region.”

He said the two ministers also reviewed bilateral ties, discussing trade, investment, energy, connectivity, science and technology, and mobility. They also exchanged views on the conflict in Ukraine and the situation in West Asia.

The Ministry of External Affairs had earlier described the attack on the commercial vessel as a matter of “grave concern” and said such actions undermined the safety, security and stability of international maritime commerce. India told the Russian envoy that attacks targeting commercial shipping and resulting in the loss of innocent civilian lives were unacceptable and should not be repeated.

India has consistently maintained that the conflict in Ukraine should be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy.

Trump

of pharmaceutical products to the US, which made up 38 per cent of its total global pharma exports of USD 25.8 billion, according to data from the Global Trade Research Initiative. These are the medicines doctors commonly prescribe for conditions like high blood pressure, diabetes, cancer, infections and mental health issues.

The announcement follows comments made days earlier by US Trade Representative Jamie Greer, who told the New York Times that Washington was working on fresh tariffs to replace those the Supreme Court had struck down earlier this year. Under this plan, the administration is looking at new tariffs of 10 to 12.5 per cent on roughly 60 countries, India included, citing concerns over forced labour and unfair trade practices. Greer said the approach was based on economics, not politics. “This is not a foreign policy shop. This is an economics shop here,” he said, adding that even close allies like the European Union face scrutiny when they block American farm goods.

The New York Times report noted that generic drugs, including statins and antibiotics, cover about 90 per cent of prescriptions filled in the US, most of them made in India using ingredients largely sourced from China. Both parties in Washington have flagged this as a security concern.

Doctors and supply chain experts have pushed back strongly, warning that taxing imported generics could raise prices, cause shortages and force rationing. John Murphy III, head of the Association for Accessible Medicines, said his industry would work with lawmakers “to pursue solutions that restore the generics industry to growth and to prioritise its place as a critical national security asset here in the US.”

Rahul

What have they done to have security forces aiming weapons at them, to be beaten up, to be thrashed.” “They are protesting peacefully, asking for what this country owes them. They are simply asking as students in this country-

‘we deserve an education system that is fair’. Children have committed suicides, they go through unlimited stress and there is a legitimate, very deep problem in this country, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said.

The former Congress president claimed 152 paper leaks have taken place in the last decade. “There have been zero convictions despite 152 paper leaks. A group of people are destroying our education system and the lives of our students,” he added.

“Every month lakhs of students are told that all the stress you went through, you will have to undergo it again and ‘we don’t give a damn,’ Gandhi said. He added that 7.5 crore students were affected by the breakdown of the education system.

Annual exam expense of families is Rs 1.32 lakh crore, which is nearly equal to the education budget of Rs 1.4 lakh crore, Gandhi claimed. “This is pure theft from these families, and after you steal from them you tell them the paper is leaked,” he said, hitting out at the government. The second reason why students are protesting is that after acquiring education, students are told that the doors that were opened to you are now closed.

“So manufacturing is closed, entrepreneurship is closed, corporate jobs are closed, public sector is closed. The only choice they have is a government job. Then you rig the system and make it unaffordable. We are 100 per cent in agreement with students. There must be some consequences,” he said.

Gandhi demanded that the Education Minister. Dharmendra Pradhan should be relieved of his duties as he has shown that he is incapable of running this system.

His remarks came a day after he, along with his sister and Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi,MP, and Samajwadi Party’s (SP) Akhilesh Yadav, were forcibly removed by police after they held a sit-in protest outside Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s residence here, demanding his resignation.

Responding to a question on his near future strategy, Gandhi claimed that the police personnel who dragged him away from the sit-in last evening outside the PM’s residence had whispered to him that they wanted the BJP government gone and that they were acting only because the uniform obliged them to follow orders.

Gandhi told reporters that the officers told him they had no liking for the government themselves, and would not have dealt with him or with the protesting students as they did had the choice been theirs.

Gandhi, who arrived wearing a black band across his shoulder, was dismissive of his own treatment, calling it an honour to express the will of the people and saying he was used to being punched and was happy to take more.

He questioned why armed personnel had been deployed against the protesters. The students were committing no crime, he said, and were asking only for an education system that worked.

Setting out their demands as his own, Gandhi said Dharmendra Pradhan should resign, that everyone who assaulted students must be held accountable, and that PM Modi must apologise to them. “We are one hundred per cent in agreement with what the students are doing,” he said.

Explaining Tuesday’s march to the PM’s residence, Gandhi said the Opposition’s natural place was Parliament, but that if students were on the streets, the government should be too. He was detained after a standoff lasting about three hours, taken to Chhatrasal Stadium and released later in the night.

WORKERS OF THE BJP AND THE CONGRESS CAME TO BLOWS IN PATNA

Congress and BJP battle on streets as student agitation spirals

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI/HYDERABAD: The spiralling agitation over the NEET issue saw protests and counter-protests by Congress and BJP across the country on Wednesday, with clashes and tense face-offs at many places, a day after Rahul Gandhi and other opposition leaders were forcibly removed from a dharna outside the prime minister's residence.

While Congress leaders and workers were angry over the police "high-handedness" and "ill-treatment" of party leaders, who were detained and later released on Tuesday night, the BJP protested against what it said was "unruly and anarchist behaviour" of Gandhi and opposition leaders.

Backing the protesting students, Gandhi on Wednesday demanded Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over examination irregularities, an apology from Prime Minister Narendra Modi for the violence on Monday, action against those involved in assaulting students and education reforms.

Leaders and workers of both parties, led by their state chiefs at many places, tried to march to each other's offices but were stopped by police,



People clash during the 'Lok Bhavan March' in Patna PTI

Highlights

- » Congress leaders and workers were angry over the police "high-handedness" and "ill-treatment" of party leaders, who were detained and later released on Tuesday night
- » The BJP protested against what it said was "unruly and anarchist behaviour" of Gandhi and opposition leaders
- » Workers of the BJP and the Congress came to blows in Patna when cadres of the ruling party took out a procession, accusing the opposition of unleashing "anarchy"

tests, triggering tension. Both parties accused each other of violence and provocation.

Workers of the BJP and the Congress came to blows in Patna when cadres of the ruling party took out a procession, accusing the opposition of unleashing "anarchy".

The BJP march, led by state president Sanjay Saraogi, proceeded to the gates of the Bihar Pradesh Congress Committee (BPCC) headquarters at Sadaqat Ashram, with party workers carrying posters and banners against Gandhi.

Police intervened after Congress workers armed with bamboo sticks confronted the BJP procession, leading to a clash. Several persons from both sides were seen bleeding profusely. The BJP and Congress battled on the streets as students and other parties held protests at many places in solidarity with the CJP's stir, including in Patna.

Keep citizens at the heart of reforms: PM Modi to secretaries

Stresses need for a whole-of-government approach

OUR CORRESPONDENT

He suggested undertaking a comprehensive mapping of emerging requirements across various ministries and departments

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday emphasised that the welfare of citizens must remain at the heart of all reforms and such initiatives designed around people's needs should gather real momentum and deliver meaningful transformation.

Chairing a high-level meeting with secretaries to review progress of rural development, agriculture, social welfare and allied sectors towards 'Viksit Bharat' goals, Modi stressed that the objective of reforms is not merely to improve the functioning of the government, but to accelerate India's journey towards becoming a developed nation.

"The prime minister emphasised that the welfare of citizens must remain at the heart of all reforms. He said that reforms designed around people's needs should gather real momentum and deliver meaningful transformation," a state-

ment issued by the PMO said. Modi highlighted that governance systems are witnessing rapid changes and stressed the importance of adapting and strengthening governance processes to effectively meet the needs of a dynamic and evolving environment.

He suggested undertaking a comprehensive mapping of emerging requirements across various ministries and departments. The PM stressed the need for a whole-of-government approach to achieve the nation's development goals.

He emphasised that the dream to build a 'Viksit Bharat' (Developed India) should become a 'Jan Andolan' (people's movement) and India's youth should form the foundation of this vision.

Modi underscored the importance of tackling the serious issue of drug abuse among youth. He suggested that efforts should be made to develop an institutional mechanism to break departmental silos and foster greater inter-departmental coordination and convergence in youth-centric initiatives.

The PM further emphasised the need to adopt an integrated approach for the development of sports. He noted that with sports tourism emerging as a key focus area, India should aspire to host major international sporting events to establish itself as a global sports hub.

He stressed the importance of promoting technology and fostering innovation through startups in the sports sector.

Kalyan Banerjee suspended from Lok Sabha for 'unpalatable' language

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI/KOLKATA: Trinamool Congress Lok Sabha MP and Mamata Banerjee loyalist Kalyan Banerjee was suspended for the remainder of the Monsoon Session on Wednesday for using "unpalatable" language against women members.

After the Lower House was adjourned in the morning, Banerjee had a heated exchange with former colleagues Shatabdi Roy, Mitali Bagh and Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar. Sources said Banerjee had referred to the NCPI leaders as 'nefarious' in a satirical tone. Mitali Bagh and Shatabdi Roy subsequently met Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla to raise

the issue. When the House resumed at 2 pm, presiding officer Krishna Prasad Tenneti referred to a complaint filed against Banerjee and said his remarks had hurt the dignity of the House. Union minister Arjun Ram Meghwal then moved a resolution seeking his suspension, which was passed by voice vote amid opposition sloganeering over the NEET paper leak and other issues.

The suspension took immediate effect. Banerjee again had a heated exchange with NCPI members present in the House before opposition MPs intervened. He later left the chamber.

"What will they get by suspending me from here? It is a party of barely twenty people.

They held a meeting in Kolkata after a month and a half. They do not even have twenty voters. Not a single person has voted for them in West Bengal. They are all traitors and dishonest people. The government will fall after a year," Banerjee told mediapersons outside Parliament.

Kakoli said the incident was "nothing new", alleging that Banerjee was a misogynist who had repeatedly used unparliamentary language against women. BJP leader Sukanta Majumdar said Banerjee had been behaving similarly at various places and was perhaps frustrated by the current state of his party. "He should take some rest," Majumdar said.

Ram Temple Trust defers General Secy, CEO decision

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust on Wednesday deferred the appointment of a permanent General Secretary and the Ram Temple's first Chief Executive Officer (CEO), with trustees failing to arrive at a consensus during a crucial meeting held in the wake of the donation embezzlement case.

Acting General Secretary Krishna Mohan will continue in office, while the Trust fixed September 2 for its next meeting, when the appointments are expected to be finalised.

The two-hour meeting, held from 3 pm to 5 pm at Shri Swami Mani Ram Das Ji Maharaj Chhawani under the chairmanship of Trust president Mahant Nritya Gopal Das, focused on administrative

SBI's role under scrutiny after donation theft

restructuring and measures to tighten oversight of temple finances after the alleged diversion of donations.

In a significant development, the Trust expressed dissatisfaction with the State Bank of India's response after irregularities in the donation counting process surfaced. It directed its finance committee to review the Trust's banking relationship with SBI and examine the existing standard operating procedures before taking a final decision.

The Trust, however, could not deliberate on the findings of the Special Investigation Team probing the alleged embezzle-

ment as the final investigation report has not yet been submitted. Trustees also took note of proceedings pending before the Allahabad High Court in connection with the case.

The board reviewed security arrangements at the temple and expressed satisfaction that access to the CCTV camera network, including cameras monitoring the donation counting centre, has now been provided to all security officials to strengthen surveillance and accountability. It also approved continuation of the existing system under which the Reserve Bank of India's subsidiary, the Mint, tests the purity and quantity of gold and silver offerings made by devotees.

The meeting discussed six key agenda items, including filling three permanent trustee vacancies created by the resig-

nation of former General Secretary Champat Rai, trustee Dr Anil Mishra and the death of trustee Raja Ayodhya Vimlendra Mohan Pratap Mishra.

The appointment of a new General Secretary also remained inconclusive. Acting General Secretary Krishna Mohan, a retired Indian Forest Service officer, and Vishwa Hindu Parishad General Secretary Bajrang Lal Bagra are understood to be the front-runners for the post vacated by Champat Rai.

The Trust also reviewed the selection process for its first CEO, a post being created to professionalise the administration of the temple. More than 5,500 applications have been received from across the country, but trustees decided to defer the appointment until the next meeting.

BJP seeks strict action in Punjab exam racket

CHANDIGARH: BJP general secretary Tarun Chugh on Wednesday demanded the strictest action against those associated with a cheating racket that was unearthed during the pharmacy officer recruitment examination conducted by the Baba Farid University of Health Sciences in Punjab.

He alleged that it is one of the "biggest betrayals" of Punjab under the Aam Aadmi Party government headed by Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann.

Nearly 7,000 candidates appeared in the examination for 454 posts across 25 centres in Faridkot, Kotkapura and Ferozepur on July 19, the Rajya Sabha MP pointed out.

However, investigators discovered a sophisticated cheating network involving hidden pen cameras, concealed earpieces and battery-operated wireless devices through which answers were being transmitted in real time inside examination halls, Chugh said in a statement.

The Punjab Police on Sunday dismantled the highly-sophisticated, inter-state cheating racket operating during the pharmacy officer examination.

Seven key conspirators and 28 candidates were arrested, with police also seizing 27 battery-operated wireless cheating devices. Police had detected the use of pen cameras and real-time dictation during the exam.

SC refuses to cancel Chaitanya Baghel's bail

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Wednesday dismissed two separate pleas of the Enforcement Directorate and the Chhattisgarh government challenging the bail granted to Chaitanya Baghel, son of former chief minister and senior Congress leader Bhupesh Baghel, in alleged liquor scam cases.

While dismissing the pleas of probe agencies against grant of bail to Baghel, the top court flagged the growing practice of routinely challenging bail orders and said it has led to a "significant expansion of bail jurisprudence, prompting the court to examine whether a legally flawed bail order, by itself, is sufficient to justify cancellation of an accused's liberty".

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joyimalya Bagchi and V Mohana, however, expunged the adverse remarks made by the Chhattisgarh High Court against the Economic Offence wing of the state police probe while granting bail to Baghel.

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) and the EOW wing of the police have filed separate pleas challenging the bail granted by the high court in the case and a related money laundering matter.

While the state government alleged that Chaitanya Baghel was one of the prime accused and masterminds in the sensational case, his counsel had argued that the high court delivered a well-considered judgement in the case in which the probe was ongoing for the last two years.

On January 2, the high court granted bail to Chaitanya Baghel in two cases linked to the alleged liquor scam.

The single bench of Justice Arvind Kumar Verma allowed Chaitanya Baghel's bail pleas in a case lodged by the ED and another by the Chhattisgarh Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB)/EOW.

Lalit Modi plans India return after relief in IPL FEMA case

NEW DELHI: Former IPL chairman Lalit Modi on Wednesday said he plans to visit India later this year or early next year after receiving major legal relief from the Appellate Tribunal in the long-running 2009 IPL South Africa foreign exchange case, describing the ruling as the vindication of a 16-year battle.

In a video message posted on social media, Modi said the tribunal's verdict had finally established the truth behind his stand on the case.

"I'm really happy with the verdict. It's really been a great day. Sixteen years I have fought and whatever I have been saying to the media and to everybody has finally emerged as the



truth," Modi said.

The Appellate Tribunal under the Smugglers and Foreign Exchange Manipulators (Forfeiture of Property) Act (SAFEMA) on Tuesday set aside key penalties imposed by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) against Modi and other former BCCI officials in connection with the conduct of the 2009 IPL in South Africa.

The tribunal held that the foreign remittances in question

were current account transactions that did not require prior RBI approval and also ruled that Modi was not responsible for ensuring the BCCI's compliance with the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA). Modi, who has been living in London since leaving India in 2010 amid multiple investigations, said the legal chapter was now behind him.

"I'm going to move on in my life and I'm looking forward to coming back to India. Yes, I will come back probably at the end of this year or early next year. My daughter is due with my grandson in October and hopefully everything will be well and I'll be back in India," he said.

'India needs you, not in suffering, but in service': Oppn MPs to Wangchuk

NEW DELHI: Assuring Sonam Wangchuk that his message had resonated across the country and would now be raised in Parliament, a delegation of opposition MPs urged the activist to end his indefinite hunger strike that entered its 25th day on Wednesday over alleged examination irregularities.

The delegation, which included Congress MP Vivek Tankha, TMC MP Sagarikha Ghose and CPI(M) MP John Brittas, met Wangchuk and his wife Gitanjali J Angmo at Medanta Hospital in Gurugram. They appealed to the activist to withdraw his indefinite fast, saying the struggle for a fair and transparent examination system had become a national cause.

Wangchuk has been on an indefinite hunger strike for the last 25 days in support of students demanding accountability over alleged examination



A portrait of climate activist Sonam Wangchuk at Jantar Mantar PTI

irregularities.

"The nation, especially its youth, needs your wisdom and guidance far more than your sacrifice... Just as the Union Territory of Ladakh needs Sonam Wangchuk, India needs you too... not in suffering, but in service, serving those causes that will benefit generations to come. The country needs you," the MPs said in a letter handed over to the activist.

After the meeting, Ghose said the delegation had appealed to Wangchuk to end his fast while extending complete support to the students' movement. In their letter, the MPs said Wangchuk's "selfless commitment to the cause of India's youth".

Morbidity gap widening across most countries since 1990, study finds

In India, morbidity gap in 2023 was 10.6 years, up from 8.4 years in 1990

NEW DELHI: Healthy life expectancy fell short of total life expectancy by 10.7 years in 2023, up from 8.8 years in 1990, revealing that people world over are living longer, but spending more years in poor health, according to a study published in The Lancet Public Health journal.

Estimates also suggest that globally, people spent an average of 14.5 per cent of their lives in poor health in 2023, up from 13.6 per cent in 1990.

Further, instead of occurring only in the final years of life, the widening morbidity gap -- the difference between total life expectancy and healthy life expectancy -- was observed across the adult lifespan, suggesting that people are spending more years living with disease and disability throughout adulthood, researchers, including those from the Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation (IHME) at the US' University of Washington, said.

Key Points

- » Women consistently lived longer than men but also showed a larger morbidity gap compared to men, indicating that women spend more years living in poor health -- with disease and disability -- across every region and level of development, the analysis revealed
- » In India, the morbidity gap in 2023 was 10.6 years, up from 8.4 years



in 1990 -- total life expectancy was 71.6 years in 2023 and 58.5 years in 1990, while healthy life expectancy was 61.0 years in 2023 and 50.1 years in 1990, the study shows.

health will come not only from helping people live longer, but from helping them live healthier," senior author Christopher Murray, director of the Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation at the University of Washington's school of medicine.

"Progress in healthy aging should be measured not only

by lifespan, but by healthspan, with greater investment in prevention, long-term disease management, and chronic care to reduce years lived in poor health," Murray said. The analysis is based on Global Burden of Disease (GBD) 2023 estimates, coordinated by the University of Washington.

Women consistently lived longer than men but also showed a larger morbidity gap compared to men, indicating that women spent more years living in poor health -- with disease and disability -- across every region and level of development, the analysis revealed.

The pattern shows that longer life expectancy among women has not translated into the same gains in healthy years, the researchers said.

In 2023, women globally experienced an average morbidity gap of 12.1 years, compared with 9.3 years for men.

Morbidity gap for men in India increased from 7.5 years in 1990 to 9.1 years in 2023,

while that for women increased from 9.4 years in 1990 to 12 years in 2023. "Women are living longer than men almost everywhere in the world, but they are also spending more of those additional years in poor health," co-author Catherine Bisignano, senior scientific writer at IHME, said.

"Improving healthy aging will require greater focus on the conditions and risk factors that drive years lived with disability. Addressing these earlier through prevention and better long-term care could have meaningful social, health system, and economic impacts," Bisignano said.

Musculoskeletal disorders, particularly low back pain, were the largest contributor to the morbidity gap for both the sexes worldwide, followed by mental disorders such as depression and anxiety.

Years spent in poor health were largely linked to preventable or manageable risk factors.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: More than 57% of requests received by the Indian Railways' e-ticketing system over the past six months were generated by automated bots and blocked before they could access the reservation platform, the Centre informed the Lok Sabha on Wednesday.

Replying to a starred question on unauthorised Tatkal ticket bookings, Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said that, on average, 8.88 billion of the 15.38 billion requests received by the e-ticketing system each month between January and June 2026 were bot-generated, accounting for 57.74% of the total traffic.

June recorded the highest share of bot traffic, with 12.61 billion of the 19.12 billion requests (65.95%) identified as bots. The corresponding figures were 12.08 billion of 20.07 billion requests (60.18%) in May, 10.64 billion of 17.33 billion (61.39%) in April, 5.71 billion of 12.44 billion (45.90%) in March, 5.01 billion of 11.01

billion (45.50%) in February and 7.26 billion of 12.35 billion (58.78%) in January.

The minister said the Railways' reservation system is equipped with industry-standard cybersecurity controls and multiple layers of protection to prevent automated form-filling tools, cyberattacks and fraudulent Tatkal bookings. Among the key measures introduced are mandatory Aadhaar authentication for online Tatkal bookings, Aadhaar-based OTP verification on selected trains, anti-bot solutions and round-the-clock security monitoring, along with enhanced network security and other safeguards.

The government also said 3.04 crore suspicious user IDs had been deactivated and another 6.22 crore accounts had been placed under revalidation during 2025-26 and 2026-27 up to June 30.

Besides, 13,343 suspicious email domains were blocked, and 530 complaints related to suspicious bookings were lodged on the National Cyber Crime Portal during the same period.

CCTVS IN POLICE STATIONS

Things moving very well, have taken positive turn, says SC

“Investigations have revealed increasing use of digital platforms such as WhatsApp, Telegram, Snapchat, Zangi and social media platforms by organised drug trafficking syndicates operating in Punjab and adjoining States for coordinating procurement, transportation, concealment and distribution of narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances,” he said.



EDITORIAL
HEALTHCARE
ECONOMICS

Trump’s announcement that imported generic medicines will face a 100 per cent tariff from August 2028 and 200 per cent a year later is presented as industrial policy: give drugmakers two years to build American plants or face a prohibitive penalty. Yet medicines are not ordinary merchandise, and generic drugs are the least suitable instruments for tariff brinkmanship. They account for more than nine out of every ten prescriptions filled in the United States, while representing only a small fraction of prescription spending. Their value rests on low prices, competition and dependable volumes. A levy designed to punish foreign manufacturers could therefore punish American patients first—through higher pharmacy bills, fewer suppliers and deeper shortages.

The case for strengthening domestic pharmaceutical capacity is not frivolous. The pandemic exposed the risks of geographically concentrated supply chains, while dependence on imported active pharmaceutical ingredients and finished medicines has become a national-security concern in Washington. But factories cannot be transplanted across continents merely because a tariff clock has begun ticking. Generic manufacturing operates on thin margins, stringent regulatory approvals and large economies of scale. Building a US facility involves high labour costs, compliance, specialised equipment and years of validation before commercial production begins. A 200 per cent tariff may make imports unviable, but it does not automatically make domestic production commercially sustainable. Without predictable procurement, faster approvals, tax support and guaranteed demand, some manufacturers may simply withdraw products.

That possibility should worry the United States. Generic competition has been one of the strongest forces restraining its notoriously high healthcare costs. The US Food and Drug Administration says competition from even a few generic entrants sharply reduces prices. Industry data show generics and biosimilars filled 90 per cent of prescriptions in 2024 but accounted for only 12 per cent of drug spending. Yet this low-price system is fragile: most current drug shortages involve generic medicines, particularly sterile injectables, where manufacturing failures or supplier exits rapidly become public-health emergencies. Tariffs could intensify this vulnerability by squeezing offshore producers before adequate American capacity exists. Strategic resilience requires additional suppliers and diversified production—not abruptly excluding existing ones.

For India, the threat is unmistakable. The United States absorbs roughly a third to two-fifths of India’s pharmaceutical exports, and the overwhelming majority of those shipments are generics. Indian manufacturers have become central to American access because they combine regulatory experience, scale and low-cost production. The new policy therefore challenges one of India’s most successful export industries. It will accelerate an existing strategic shift: larger companies will acquire US assets, expand local manufacturing, enter higher-margin speciality segments and use American subsidiaries to protect market access. Sun Pharma’s agreement to acquire Organon at about \$11.75 billion illustrates the scale of this repositioning. But relocation is easier for large firms than for smaller manufacturers, which may lose market share or be forced into partnerships.

India should resist both panic and complacency. Trump has repeatedly used tariff threats as leverage, while earlier pharmaceutical proposals were delayed, narrowed or left unimplemented. The two-year exemption creates space for diplomacy and corporate adjustment. New Delhi should seek a negotiated carve-out based on India’s contribution to US medicine affordability and supply security, while pressing for recognition of investments already made by Indian companies in American plants and distribution networks. It should also coordinate with US hospitals, insurers, pharmacies and patient groups, which have an interest in preventing price increases. The strongest Indian argument is not merely that its exporters deserve protection, but that American healthcare depends on uninterrupted access to their products.

At home, the episode should trigger overdue reform. India remains vulnerable because much of its success is concentrated in low-margin formulations and because important raw materials continue to come from abroad, notably China. Production-linked incentives must be judged by whether they create globally competitive capacity in active ingredients, fermentation products and complex generics—not simply by the number of subsidised plants announced. Regulators must improve inspection credibility, companies must invest more heavily in compliance and research, and exporters must diversify towards Europe, Latin America, Africa and emerging Asian markets. India should also move up the value chain into biosimilars, speciality drugs, novel delivery systems and contract development.

Health security cannot be built through tariff walls alone. The United States needs greater domestic capacity; India needs deeper technological capability and wider markets. Both goals are legitimate. But a disorderly rupture would leave American patients paying more and Indian manufacturers losing a vital market, while doing little to create reliable new supply. A sensible transition would combine incentives for US production with gradual localisation, long-term purchasing commitments and exemptions for medicines at risk of shortage. Trump’s tariff ultimatum may succeed in attracting investment, but if it undermines the affordable-drug ecosystem before alternatives are ready, it will become a costly prescription for the very patients it claims to protect.

NEXUS
OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP
THE WRITER IS
AN AUTHOR AND
A FORMER
CIVIL SERVANT

Founded by Dr Satya Prasad Koneru, HEAL provides vulnerable children with education, healthcare, shelter, skills and the support required to build independent lives

CIVIC
DISCIPLINE



KM PRASHANTH
THE WRITER IS
A FORMER GM
(CORPORATE
COMMUNICATION),
NTPC

Every society offers lessons worth learning—Japan exemplifies punctuality, Singapore civic discipline, and Europe the importance of respecting pedestrians and sharing public space

From Shelter to Self-Reliance

From a 26-child home in Guntur to a global volunteer-led movement, HEAL has transformed over 16,000 lives through education, healthcare, rehabilitation and residential care

HEAL (Health and Education for All) is a registered charitable society under the Societies Registration Act, XXI of 1860 (Registration No. 138 of 1993). Established in India in 1993 following its inception in the United Kingdom in 1992, HEAL is a volunteer-driven humanitarian organisation dedicated to transforming the lives of orphaned, underprivileged, and disadvantaged children through quality education, healthcare, residential care, disability rehabilitation, and community development.

The roots of HEAL can be traced back to 1967, when Dr Satya Prasad Koneru, then a medical student at Guntur Medical College, founded the Praja Seva Samithi (People Service Society) along with fellow students. The organisation established medical centres for slum dwellers, book banks and mid-day meal programmes for poor students, and rehabilitation services for visually impaired and differently abled individuals. These early initiatives shaped Dr Koneru’s lifelong commitment to serving vulnerable communities through sustainable institutions rather than temporary relief.

After moving to the United Kingdom in 1976 for advanced medical training, Dr Koneru established a successful family medical practice in one of the country’s most deprived communities. Guided by the conviction that quality education and healthcare should be accessible to every individual irrespective of economic status, he founded HEAL as a registered charity in the UK in 1992. The following year, HEAL India was established with a deeply personal contribution when Dr Koneru donated his ancestral home, “Ankitha,” in Guntur to establish a residential home for 26 orphaned children. That humble beginning has since grown into one of India’s respected charitable organisations dedicated to child welfare and education.

Today, HEAL has registered charitable chapters in the United Kingdom, India, the United States, Australia, and Spain. The organisation is unique in being entirely volunteer-managed, enabling vir-



HEAL’s sustained commitment to excellence has earned widespread recognition at the state, national, and international levels

tually every donation to be utilised directly for the benefit of children and community welfare programmes without administrative overheads.

HEAL firmly believes that education is the most effective means of breaking the cycle of poverty. Every child entering a HEAL institution becomes part of one extended family and receives comprehensive support until he or she becomes an educated, independent, and responsible citizen. Since its inception, HEAL has supported more than 16,000 orphaned, vulnerable, and economically disadvantaged children through integrated programmes in education, healthcare, residential care, vocational training, disability rehabilitation, and community welfare.

The organisation’s flagship initiative is HEAL Paradise, located on a picturesque 30-acre campus at Thotapalli Village, Agiripalli Mandal, Eluru District, Andhra Pradesh. Developed as a model residential educational community, the campus provides a safe and nurturing environment for orphaned and destitute children from different parts of India. At present, 921 children receive completely free food, accommodation, CBSE English-medium education, uniforms, books, healthcare, and holistic care in separate residential facilities for boys and girls.

HEAL School offers edu-

cation from Classes I to XII exclusively for orphaned, underprivileged, and disadvantaged children. Academic excellence remains one of the institution’s hallmarks. To date, nine batches of Class X students have achieved a 100% pass rate in the CBSE Board Examinations. Similarly, five batches of Class XII students secured a 100% pass percentage, while the latest batch recorded an impressive 96% pass rate, reflecting the school’s consistent commitment to academic quality.

Believing that every child deserves opportunities beyond the classroom, HEAL places equal emphasis on sports, physical education, music, dance, drama, arts, leadership, and value-based education. Students have won numerous awards at mandal, district, state, and national levels in athletics, cultural competitions, music, and other extracurricular activities. The campus also features excellent sports infrastructure that supports the all-round development of every child.

Preparing children for future careers is another important priority. Through its Skill Development Centre, HEAL provides industry-oriented training in emerging technologies. Students completing Class XII have the opportunity to pursue specialised one-year programmes in Artificial Intelligence and Cyber Security, with placement assistance provided to success-

ful candidates, equipping them for employment in the rapidly evolving digital economy.

HEAL Paradise also houses a dedicated Institute for the Visually Challenged, where 41 visually impaired students receive free residential education, rehabilitation, mobility training, assistive technology, and life skills. The institute enables children with visual disabilities to pursue education confidently in an inclusive and supportive environment.

Healthcare forms an equally important pillar of HEAL’s mission. The HEAL Artificial Limb Centre, established in 2015, provides artificial limbs completely free of cost to children and adults with disabilities. The centre has so far distributed more than 912 artificial limbs, restoring mobility, confidence, and independence to beneficiaries. The campus also hosts the L.V. Prasad Eye Institute Rural Extension Centre, bringing quality eye care services closer to rural communities.

Beyond the Paradise campus, HEAL operates the HEAL Children’s Village in Guntur, where around 250 orphaned children receive residential care, education, nutrition, healthcare, and emotional support in a family-like environment under the care of dedicated house mothers.

HEAL also manages HEAL School at Bhadrachalam, Telangana, where more than 480 chil-

dren from tribal, migrant, and economically disadvantaged families receive free English-medium education, uniforms, books, and nutritious meals. These initiatives have enabled hundreds of first-generation learners to continue their education and aspire to a better future.

To extend quality healthcare to economically weaker communities, HEAL established the Health and Education Centre at Punjagutta, Hyderabad. The centre provides affordable outpatient consultations, laboratory services, pharmacy facilities, preventive healthcare, digital medical records, and health education. It also functions as a hub for teacher training, educational programmes, seminars, workshops, and community outreach. In addition, HEAL regularly conducts free medical camps in villages and urban slums, ensuring that healthcare reaches those who need it most.

HEAL’s sustained commitment to excellence has earned widespread recognition at the state, national, and international levels. In 2017, Dr Satya Prasad Koneru was recognised by the Queen of Great Britain for his outstanding philanthropic service through HEAL. The HEAL Paradise campus received the Second Place Green Award in Andhra Pradesh from the Andhra Pradesh Greening and Beautification Corporation in 2018 for its environmental stewardship and green campus initiatives. In 2020, HEAL School was recognised among India’s Innovative Schools by the Centre for Innovations in Public Systems (CIPS), Hyderabad, acknowledging its pioneering educational practices. HEAL was honoured with the Best Social Project Towards Education Award at the Asia Education Conclave Educational Summit in 2023. Continuing its journey of excellence, HEAL was ranked India’s Second Best Philanthropy School by C Fore Rankings in 2025 and was also recognised among the Top 10 CBSE Schools in Andhra Pradesh by Brainfeed for excellence in education, infrastructure, and sports.

HEAL presents a wonderful example of Nexus of Good. Here is a model that can be replicated and scaled through public-private partnership.

Views expressed are personal

India’s Behavioural Bottleneck

Comparing Bali and India reveals that civic discipline, mutual respect and patience can transform congested roads more effectively than infrastructure alone

Whenever we discuss India’s traffic problems, the conversation invariably turns to inadequate infrastructure. We point to narrow roads, poor planning, rapid urbanisation and the ever-growing number of vehicles. These are undeniable realities. Yet, a recent visit to Bali in Indonesia made me wonder whether our greatest challenge is not the state of our roads, but the state of our driving culture.

Bali is hardly blessed with world-class road infrastructure. Much of the island is mountainous, with narrow, winding roads connecting bustling tourist destinations such as Kuta, Ubud and Uluwatu. Tourism is the lifeblood of its economy, attracting millions of visitors every year. During peak hours, these roads carry a constant stream of cars, tourist buses and thousands of motorcycles.

By Indian standards, one would expect such conditions to result in endless traffic snarls, blaring horns and impatient motorists. Instead, what I witnessed was a remarkable display of courtesy and discipline.

The first thing that struck me was the silence. Despite heavy traffic, I rarely heard anyone use the horn. At busy intersections without traffic signals, motorists slowed down, acknowledged one another and took turns to move ahead. There was no desperate scramble to gain a few extra metres, no attempt to force one’s way into every available gap. Traffic moved slowly, but it moved continuously.

Equally impressive was the relationship between cars and motorcycles. The roads were packed with two-wheelers, yet there was little evidence of conflict. Both appeared to anticipate each other’s movements and shared the limited road space with surprising ease. It was a lesson in cooperation rather than competition.



India may need wider roads, but it needs broader civic responsibility even more

Another feature that caught my attention was the absence of unnecessary overtaking. Drivers generally remained in their lanes and followed the vehicle ahead instead of weaving through traffic in search of marginal advantage. They seemed to understand that disciplined driving benefits everyone, whereas aggressive driving benefits no one.

Our own driver personified this attitude. Whenever a pedestrian wished to cross or another vehicle needed to merge into traffic, he instinctively slowed down and gave way. There was no visible irritation or reluctance. Courtesy seemed to be an integral part of driving rather than an act of generosity. Watching him, I could not help thinking that the unwritten philosophy of Bali’s motorists was “Commuters First.”

That experience prompted an uncomfortable question. Why is such behaviour so uncommon on Indian roads?

We often defend aggressive driv-

ing by arguing that congestion leaves us with little choice. Yet, the opposite is frequently true. Constant lane changing, unnecessary overtaking, indiscriminate honking and the refusal to yield often create the very bottlenecks we complain about. Every driver tries to save a few seconds, but collectively everyone ends up losing far more time.

The consequences extend well beyond delays. Road rage has become increasingly common. Pedestrians, cyclists and elderly citizens often struggle to find safe space on our roads. Excessive honking contributes to noise pollution, raises stress levels and diminishes the quality of urban life. Most importantly, India continues to record one of the highest numbers of road fatalities in the world, many of which stem not only from infrastructure deficiencies but also from unsafe driving behaviour.

To be fair, Bali and India are not directly comparable. Bali is a relatively small island, while India is a vast

nation with a much larger population, far greater vehicle density and infinitely more complex traffic conditions. No one can expect the two to function identically.

Yet, every society has something to learn from another. Japan has demonstrated the value of punctuality, Singapore the importance of civic discipline, and several European countries the benefits of respecting pedestrians and enforcing lane discipline. Bali offers a lesson that is equally relevant: traffic management is as much about attitude as it is about engineering.

There is no doubt that India needs better roads, more efficient public transport and smarter traffic management systems. These investments are essential. But infrastructure alone cannot solve our traffic problems. Unless our behaviour behind the wheel changes, even the widest highways will eventually become congested.

Fortunately, changing behaviour costs far less than building infrastructure. It begins with simple habits—using the horn only when necessary, staying in one’s lane, giving way where appropriate, respecting pedestrians and accepting that every road user has an equal right to safety and courtesy. Individually, these may appear to be small acts. Collectively, they can transform the driving experience.

Travel is often celebrated for introducing us to new cultures, cuisines and landscapes. Sometimes, however, its greatest value lies in the lessons it teaches about ourselves. Bali reminded me that disciplined driving is not merely about obeying traffic rules; it is about respecting fellow human beings. If we can embrace that simple principle, our roads will become safer, our cities quieter and our journeys less stressful. That is a lesson well worth bringing home.

Views expressed are personal

RUBIO ATTENDED ASEAN MEETING IN MANILA

Iran's demands over Hormuz would set a dangerous precedent: Rubio

MANILA: US Secretary of State Marco Rubio warned Asian leaders Wednesday that Iran's demand to control and collect tolls in the Strait of Hormuz would threaten the world's economy and set a precedent that could be repeated elsewhere in the world.

Rubio spoke at the start of an annual meeting in the Philippine capital, Manila, with counterparts from the Association of Southeast Asian Nations who have expressed alarm over the resurgent war in the Middle East that has battered their region. Despite Washington's preoccupation with the war, Rubio said "we're with ASEAN 100 per cent."

"If we create a precedent in the Middle East where a nation state can decide that they are going to control an international waterway, charge a toll and if you don't pay them, blow up your ships, we have created a very dangerous precedent which will repeat



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio

itself in other parts of the world, including in this region," he said.

Washington's top diplomat also renewed allegations that Iran has reneged on commitments under a failed peace deal. Rubio said Iran "has been reaching out to the United States, both directly and indirectly, to engage in talks about settling the differences," but

gave no indication that the US was considering returning to peace talks with Iran.

Top diplomats from the US, China, Russia and several other countries are in Manila this week to take part in at the ASEAN ministerial gathering. Newly minted British Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband was arriving Wednesday, his office said.

Highlights

» The US leader said that America is with ASEAN 100%

» Washington's top diplomat renewed allegations that Iran has reneged on commitments under a failed peace deal

» Southeast Asia hit hard by energy shock from Iran war

Sergey Lavrov, Russia's foreign minister, told reporters that Moscow would like to see a quick settlement between the US and Iran.

"We would like to see it stop — it impacts the global economy and Russia is part of the global economy," Lavrov said, adding that Moscow is "interested in stable global energy prices to pursue long-term economic policies."

economic policies."

Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong underscored her country's concern over the renewed war in the Middle East, warning that "the situation could deteriorate further without much warning."

"We want to see an end to this war. We want to see a ceasefire. We want to see negotiations and we want the strait to be opened," Wong told reporters.

"People are being affected by what is happening and has happened to global energy markets and the effect on people has been direct and personal," she said.

Overreliance on fossil fuel imports from the Middle East has made Southeast Asia particularly vulnerable to the energy shock triggered by the Iran war, according to the International Energy Agency, which called the crisis a "stark wake-up call" for the region's energy security.

US okays nuclear deal that allow Saudi Arabia to enrich uranium

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump has approved an agreement with Saudi Arabia that could potentially provide the kingdom with uranium enrichment capability for its civilian nuclear program, according to two people familiar with the matter.

The people, who were not authorized to comment publicly about the yet to be formally announced decision, said the agreement is expected to be announced publicly as early as Wednesday.

The deal is expected to last 30 years and is also expected to involve U.S. firms in developing the program. The deal could allow for the building of a uranium enrichment facility in Saudi Arabia following a joint US-Saudi study.

But the deal, which is expected to be submitted to Congress for review, could face headwinds among lawmakers who fear that helping the Saudis fulfill their long-standing desire to enrich their own uranium would open new rounds of nuclear proliferation and competition.

Saudi Arabia is a member state of the International



US President Donald Trump with Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman

Atomic Energy Agency, a Vienna-based agency which promotes peaceful nuclear work but also inspects nations to ensure they don't have clandestine atomic weapons programs.

But the agreement is not expected to include the IAEA's Additional Protocol, which would allow for more monitoring, inspections and verification, according to one of the people.

The expected announcement comes in the midst of the war against Iran launched

by the U.S. and Israel, in part, to wipe out Tehran's ability to develop a nuclear weapon. Iran has insisted its nuclear enrichment program is peaceful.

The White House and Saudi officials in Riyadh did not immediately respond to requests for comment on the decision, which was first reported on by The Wall Street Journal.

Both Trump and former President Joe Biden tried to reach a nuclear deal with the kingdom to share American technology.

CHINA FURIOUS

Taiwan backs Philippines' claims over disputed sea

BEIJING: China is livid with Taiwan, which it regards as part of its own territory, for Taipei's endorsement of the Philippines' claims over the disputed South China Sea (SCS), contradicting Beijing's sweeping claim over the area.

Zhang Han, a spokesperson for China's Taiwan Affairs Office in Beijing, on Wednesday criticised Taiwan's authorities for supporting the Philippines' claims over a recent confrontation at Ren'ai Jiao islands, saying they abandoned their national position and echoed external forces in confusing right and wrong.

When asked about Taiwan's Foreign Ministry condemning the use of force by the Chinese coast guard against the Phil-

'The Democratic Progressive Party (DPP) of Taiwan chose to smear the Chinese mainland'

ippine sailors, Zhang said the ruling Democratic Progressive Party (DPP) of Taiwan chose to "smear the Chinese mainland," official media here reported.

Zhang sharply criticised Taiwan's foreign ministry, which reportedly issued a statement siding with the Philippines' claims and condemning what it described as "the mainland's use of force to harm people" during the confrontation.

Ukraine overhauls its military top brass for fight against Russia

KYIV: Ukraine pushed on with its fight against Russia's invasion under new military leadership Wednesday, after President Volodymyr Zelenskyy bowed to public pressure and fired his commander-in-chief.

Ukraine has made significant progress in the war this year, and a rift between the country's outgoing army chief and its defence minister threatened to derail its efforts. Both men lost their jobs following Zelenskyy's major government reshuffle last week. The top-level changes late Tuesday were intended to draw a line under an unwelcome spasm of political turmoil that lasted almost a week and prompted rejoicing in Russia. It was not clear whether Zelenskyy's measures would achieve that goal.

The new army chief, 43-year-old Maj Gen Mykhailo Drapaty,



Rescue workers try to put out a fire of a residential building burning after a Russian air guided bomb strike in Zaporizhzhia on Tuesday

AP/PTI

belongs to a new generation of Ukrainian generals who have come up through the ranks during the battle against Russian aggression. He became known for his daring

and courage in 2014, the year that Russia seized and illegally annexed Ukraine's Crimean Peninsula — eight years before Moscow's all-out invasion.

Firefighters in Spain battle huge wildfire

BARCELONA: Firefighters in central Spain on Wednesday battled a wildfire that has burned over 32,000 hectares (79,000 acres) in one of the largest blazes in recent memory for the southern European country. The fire in rural Guadalajara comes less than two weeks after a deadly blaze devastated a small expat community in southern Spain.

That small but extremely virulent fire killed 13 people, including several foreigners, in one of Spain's deadliest wildfires.

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez on Wednesday visited the fire-ravaged area in Guadalajara, located less than two hours by car northeast of Madrid, where some 34 villages have been evacuated.

There are no reported serious injuries or deaths.

France recorded 5,700 more deaths than usual during its historic June heatwave

France registered its hottest-ever days on June 24 and June 25 this year

PARIS: France recorded at least 5,700 more deaths than usual during a historic heatwave last month, the public health agency said Wednesday, sharply increasing its estimates of the feared toll from record-shattering temperatures.

Public Health France said regions hit by the heat from June 17 to July 2 recorded 21,674 deaths from all causes.

But without a heatwave, those same regions would have been expected to have seen far fewer deaths, or 15,910, based on statistical modelling using data from previous years, it said.



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

The difference between expected and actual deaths — a total of 5,764 — are therefore considered to be "excess" deaths during the heatwave, the

agency said.

It said the excess mortality, with 36% more deaths that would normally have been expected, was the highest from

any heatwave since 2003. A historic heatwave that year caused an estimated 15,000 deaths in France.

France registered its hottest-ever days on June 24 and June 25 this year — with a national average of 30 C (86 F) — as well as record heat at night and peak temperatures that soared well above 40 C (104 F) in many places.

Just over half of the unexpected deaths occurred during and in the immediate wake of that hottest period, over three days from June 25 to June 27, the public health agency said.

IN FIRST WEEK AS UK PM

Burnham unveils cheaper bus travel for millions

LONDON: After promising to lead a "cost-of-living government", British Prime Minister Andy Burnham on Wednesday unveiled a cap of 2 pounds on single bus fares which he hopes will make travel cheaper for millions.

During his first week in office at 10 Downing Street, Burnham said buses are a lifeline for communities, providing essential routes into work, training and education as well

as childcare, healthcare and leisure.

"Good, affordable transport links are an essential; no one should be priced out of those and left behind," said Burnham.

"As I said on my first day in office (on Monday) — I will build a country for everyone, everywhere. That means more connected communities, better access to opportunities, and a lighter load on people's lives," he added.

LOOK OUT NOTICE

MISSING CHILD

PLEASE HELP FIND THIS CHILD

Missing Since: WEDNESDAY, 20 MAY 2026, at approximately 10:00 AM.

HELP US BRING HIM HOME

The child went missing on 20 May 2026 and no information regarding his whereabouts has been received so far. Your assistance is urgently requested.

CHILD'S DETAILS

Name: Arpit Vishwakarma

Age: Approximately 11 Years

Date Missing: Wednesday, 20 May 2026

Time Missing: Around 10:00 AM

Place Missing From: Village Patpara, Majari Tola, District Sidhi, Madhya Pradesh

Height: Approximately 2.5 to 3 Feet

Complexion: Fair

Language Spoken: Hindi

Build: Normal / Thin Physique

Clothing at the Time of Missing: One Shirt, One Vest (Banian), One Half Pant (Shorts)

Footwear: Barefoot (Not Wearing Any Footwear)

Additional Information: No Further Information is Available at Present.

FAMILY DETAILS

Grandfather's Name: Ganesh Vishwakarma

Father's Name: Mahesh Vishwakarma

Mother's Name: Manita Vishwakarma

IF YOU HAVE SEEN THIS CHILD OR HAVE ANY INFORMATION PLEASE CONTACT IMMEDIATELY

FATHER: 93240 71768

MOTHER: 95160 24280

RELATIVE: 75809 61678

A MISSING PERSON REPORT HAS ALREADY BEEN LODGED WITH THE POLICE.

Police Station: District Sidhi, Madhya Pradesh

PLEASE SHARE THIS NOTICE WIDELY. Even a small piece of information can help reunite this child with his family.

YOUR ONE CALL MAY BRING A CHILD SAFELY HOME.

DIPNoDIP/16327/26

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited

(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)

(ISO 9001:2015 Certified)

1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Teibandha, Raipur, Chhattisgarh 492006

CIN: U45203CT1981SGC001853 PAN: AABCM6288N GST Regn No. 22AABCM6288N52Y

Phone: 0771-6621000, Fax: 0771-2583794

Website: www.CSIDC.in

Email address:csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

Invitation for Expression of Interest (EOI)

EOI NIT No. 07/CSIDC/EE/Division-III/2026-27/ Raipur, dated 20/07/2026

The Government of Chhattisgarh, through the Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation (CSIDC), invites reputed Agencies to submit Expressions of Interest (EOI) for the "Selection of Agency for Design, Engineering, Supply, Construction, Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Comprehensive Operation & Maintenance of Five (05) Years for proposed Effluent Treatment Plant (ETP) on Turazky Basis at Pharmaceutical Park (Phase-I) Sector-22, Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.)."

The EOI document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of work and other details can be downloaded from website www.csidc.in from 21/07/2026 and shall be submitted as detailed below:

Key Details:

Last date for Submission of EOI: 10/08/2026, 5:00 P.M.

Submission Mode: EOI should be submitted in a sealed envelope, super scribed as: "Expression of Interest (EOI)" for proposed Effluent Treatment Plant (ETP) on Turazky Basis at Pharmaceutical Park (Phase-I) Sector-22, Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.)."

Address for Submission: The Managing Director, Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation (CSIDC), 1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No. 01, Teibandha, Raipur (C.G.)-492001

For further information and clarifications, please contact:

Shri Mahendra Singh Thakur, Executive Engineer, Division-III, CSIDC

Mobile: +91 98279-57045

Email: csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

Sd/- Executive Engineer Division-III

samvad 48526/3

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Cancellation to tender no. 2026-July-01-03 dated 03.07.2026

Cancellation

Tender no. 03 of tender notice no. 2026-July-01 dated 03.07.2026 which was scheduled to be opened on 24.07.2026 may please be treated as cancelled. The details may please be seen on the Indian Railways website <http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in> and <http://www.tenders.gov.in>.

153126 (AS)

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Open Tender Notice No.: NER-BSB0sNT-OT-31-2026

"Open Tenders" through Online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecomm)/ Varanasi/ N. E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works: SN:- 1.

Tender Notice No. and Description of Work:- NER-BSB0sNT-OT-31-2026: Name of work: Provision of Multi Section Digital axle counter for redundancy and reliability improvement in complete yard to cater water logging at KHM station of Varanasi division. Details:- Approx. Value:- Rs. 30989675.33, Earnest Money:- Rs. 619800.00 /-. Cost of Tender Form:- Rs. 00.00, Completion period:- 12 Months, Tender Closing date & Time:- 17.08.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs. 1. Tender Online will be submitted up to 15 Hrs on date 17.08.2026. 2. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railways i.e. www.ireps.gov.in.

Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T) CPRO/Signal-72 Varanasi

Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

Muthoot Homefin

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office: Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400 025

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower/s (the "said Borrower"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice/s issued to them that are also given below.

In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower to pay to MHIL, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest at 2% p.m. as detailed in the said Demand Notices, from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrowers. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to MHIL by the said Borrowers respectively.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor/ Loan Account No./Branch	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Date of Demand Notice	Description of secured asset (Immovable property)
1.	Monu Kumar/ Tripti Devi/ GHA-NHL-000757/ Ghaziabad	Rs. 13,61,599/- Rupees Thirteen Lakh Sixty One Thousand Five Hundred Ninety Nine And Paise Twenty Six Only.	30-Jun-2026	House on Plot of Land Area Measuring 421 Sq. Yards I.E. 352 Sq. Meters, Out of Kharsa No. 1471, Situated at Village Pabla, Begumbabad, Pargana and Tehsil and Dist. Baghpat. Boundaries East - House Of Sombeer, West- House Of Anil, North- Ne - Pond, South- Sw-gali 8 Ft. Wide.
2.	Dharmendra Singh/ Vito/ MTH-HL-000011/ Mathura	Rs. 26,63,787/- Rupees Twenty Six Lakh Sixty One Thousand Seven Hundred Eighty Seven And Paise Twenty Six Only.	30-Jun-2026	All That Piece And Parcel Of House No. 6 Area Measuring 80 Sq. Yards, Khars No. 2158, Situated At Jaibal Kuni Near Nagla Mohanlal, Mauza Naraich, Tehsil Etamadpur & District Agra. Bounded With East: 16 Feet Wide Road, West: Jyoti Kunj Colony, North: Part Of House No. 6 of neelam, South: House No 7 of Radha Devi.

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to MHIL as aforesaid, MHIL shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of MHIL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: July 23, 2026

Place: Baghpat, Agra

Sd/-Authorized Officer, Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

Suryoday

Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

Regd. & Corp. office: 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 45, Sector - 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai - 400614, CN: 655923MH200091-2261472

Under Section 13(2) of The Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002

Whereas the undersigned is the Authorised officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd. ("SFSBL") under Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued Demand Notices under Section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s), Co-Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) to discharge in full their liability to the Company by making payment of entire outstanding including up to date interest, cost and charges within 60 days from the date of respective Notices issued and the publication of the Notice as given below as and way of alternate security upon you. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset (s) have been mortgaged to SFSBL by the said Borrower(s), Co-Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) respectively.

Name of Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice	13.07.2026
257000026033 & 257000026042, 1. MR. JAVED QURESHI S/O ABULSATTAR QURESHI, 2. MRS. SHAHANA QURESHI W/O ARIF QURESHI, 3. MRS. SHAISTA PARVEEN W/O JAVED QURESHI	Date of NPA	04.07.2026
	Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.	Rs. 65,08,906.27/- as on 07.07.2026 & 06.07.2026

Description Of Secured Asset(S) /Immovable Property (ies) :- PLOT NO 44 GSRBL FLOOR SECTOR 48, URBAN ESTATE FARIDABAD HARYANA, 121003, FARIDABAD, FARIDABAD, HARYANA. BOUNDED AS UNDER:- BOUNDRIES:- EAST :- PLOT NO.43, SOUTH: OTHERS PROPERTY, WEST: PLOT NO.45, NORTH: ROAD 30 FEET

Date : 23.07.2026, Place : Faridabad Authorised Officer, Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

SENSEX, NIFTY TANK NEARLY 1 %

Mkts decline for 3rd day on higher oil prices & selling in bank stocks

MPOST BUREAU

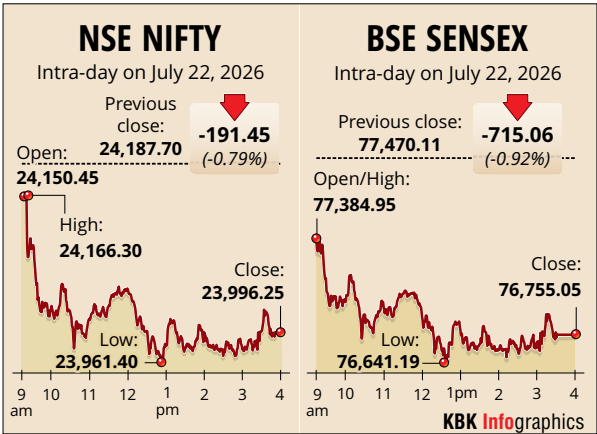
MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty tumbled nearly 1 per cent on Wednesday, taking losses to the third consecutive day, following a sharp spike in crude oil prices and selling in bank stocks.

The 30-share BSE Sensex tanked 715.06 points, or 0.92 per cent, to settle at 76,755.05. During the day, it slumped 828.92 points, or 1 per cent, to 76,641.19.

The 50-share NSE Nifty declined 191.45 points, or 0.79 per cent, to end at 23,996.25.

The BSE MidCap Select index tumbled 1.33 per cent and SmallCap Select index declined 1.16 per cent.

From the Sensex pack, InterGlobe Aviation, Infosys, State Bank of India, UltraTech Cement, ICICI Bank, and Axis Bank were among the major laggards.



Hindustan Unilever, NTPC, Power Grid, and Titan were among the winners.

Among sectors, really tanked 2.62 per cent, services (1.97 per cent), PSU bank (1.83 per cent), focused IT (1.73 per cent), MidSmall private banks quality tilt (1.63 per cent), IT (1.47 per cent) and private banks index (1.42 per cent).

FMCG emerged as the only winner. A total of 2,780 stocks declined, while 1,458 advanced and 180 remained unchanged on the BSE.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 4.68 per cent to USD 95.27 per barrel.

“Indian equities closed lower as a sharp rise in crude oil prices and persistent geo-

HIGHLIGHTS

» From the Sensex pack, InterGlobe Aviation, Infosys, State Bank of India, UltraTech Cement, ICICI Bank, and Axis Bank were among the major laggards

» A total of 2,780 stocks declined, while 1,458 advanced and 180 remained unchanged on the BSE

Enrich Money, an online trading and wealth tech firm, said.

Investor attention remained firmly on the macro backdrop as higher crude oil prices and renewed concerns over potential US tariffs on pharmaceutical imports weighed on sentiment, he added.

South Korea's KOSPI and Shanghai's SSE Composite index ended higher, while Japan's Nikkei 225 index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index settled lower. Markets in Europe were trading higher. US markets ended higher on Tuesday.

FII's turned buyers on Tuesday. They bought equities worth Rs 1,650.16 crore in the previous trade, according to exchange data.

On Tuesday, Sensex declined 238.41 points to settle at 77,470.11. The Nifty edged lower by 50.80 points to end at 24,187.70.

India-US trade deal ‘almost complete’, says US State dept

Jaishankar meets US Secy of State Rubio in Manila

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar met with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio in Manila on Wednesday to discuss priority areas including trade, tariffs, energy, defence, critical minerals, and artificial intelligence.

The US State Department said the two top diplomats agreed on the importance of finalising the interim India-US trade deal, which is “almost complete” and that they also discussed finalising “key defence agreements.” “Our relationship with India is vitally important,” the US Secretary of State said after the meeting.

They also exchanged views on the West Asia crisis and the situation in Indo-Pacific.

The external affairs minister and the US secretary of state were in the Philippine capital to participate in high-level discussions under the framework of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) and



EAM S Jaishankar meets US Secy of State Marco Rubio, in Manila PTI

the Quad grouping.

“Our meeting focused on areas which are priority for the India-US Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership, including trade and tariffs, energy, defence and security, critical minerals and artificial intelligence,” Jaishankar said on social media.

“We also exchanged quick perspectives on regional, global and multilateral issues of mutual interest,” he said.

Rubio said he and Jaishankar discussed trade, defence agreements and regional security issues. “We discussed regional security issues, the Quad, trade, and defence agreements,” he said on X.

In a brief statement, the US State Department said Rubio and Jaishankar discussed recent developments in the Middle-East and the Indo-Pacific.

“The Secretary and Minister Jaishankar discussed finalising key defence agreements in fulfillment of commitments made between President Trump and Prime Minister Modi last year,” it said without providing any details.

Expert panel seeks 22-25% mango pulp content in beverages

NEW DELHI: An expert committee constituted by the Centre has recommended that mango-based beverages be mandated to contain 22-25 per cent genuine natural mango pulp, with the concessional 5 per cent GST slab reserved only for products meeting this threshold -- a move aimed at reviving demand for Totapuri mango pulp and shoring up farm-gate prices.

The panel, headed by T Damodaran, Director of ICAR-Central Institute of Subtropical Horticulture (CISH), Lucknow, submitted its findings at a meeting chaired by Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan.

The minister has directed officials to initiate inter-ministerial consultations on the recommendations. The panel was tasked with studying the sharp fall in Totapuri mango prices this season in Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, and Karnataka — the crop's key growing belt.

Damodaran attributed the decline to a mismatch between processing capacity and procurement timelines, thin pulp content in beverages sold domestically, and volatility in global prices.

Processing units in several centres are not procuring fruit in time at the start of the season, even as arrivals from farmers peak simultaneously — a bunching effect that depresses prices and hits

The move aimed at reviving demand for Totapuri mango pulp & shoring up farm-gate prices

grower incomes, he said in an official statement.

The panel's central recommendation ties the beverage industry's tax treatment to the actual fruit content.

Products with pulp content below the prescribed floor would face a higher GST rate, while compliant products retain the 5 per cent concessional slab.

The ministry's statement said the mechanism is expected to simultaneously lift Totapuri pulp consumption and improve the nutritional quality of beverages available to consumers.

To operationalise this, an inter-ministerial meeting will be convened involving FSSAI, the GST Council, and the Ministries of Finance, Food Processing Industries, Agriculture and Health, to finalise standards and the tax structure. To bring more predictability to the value chain, the committee has recommended setting up a Central Coordination and Price Stabilisation Committee — an apex mechanism covering Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, and Karnataka. MPOST

Rupee falls 28 paise to close at 96.53 against USD

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI:The rupee depreciated by 28 paise to close at 96.53 against the US dollar on Wednesday, weighed down by surging crude oil prices and heightened geopolitical uncertainty.

Forex traders said risk aversion in global markets and a negative trend in domestic equities further dented investor sentiment.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 96.36 against the US dollar and traded in the range of 96.25 to 96.60 during the day. The domestic unit finally settled at 96.53, lower by 28 paise from its previous close.

On Tuesday, the rupee had settled higher by 11 paise at 96.25 against the dollar.

Short-term money mkt rates rise as GST outflows tighten liquidity

MUMBAI: A sharp narrowing of liquidity in the banking system following goods and services tax (GST) outflows has pushed up short-term money market rates over the past few days.

RBI data showed that cut-off yields on T-bills rose by up to around 5 bps

Data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) showed that cut-off yields on treasury bills (T-bills) rose by up to around 5 basis points or 0.05 percentage point in a week, while call money rates increased by 27 basis points during the same period. The cut-off yield on the 91-day T-bill auction held on Wednesday stood at 5.3542 per cent, compared with 5.3324 per cent on July 15.

Similarly, the 182-day T-bill yield rose to 5.6098 per cent from 5.5693 per cent a week earlier, while the 364-day T-bill yield climbed to 5.7650 per cent from 5.7197 per cent.

Market participants said the rise in short-term rates reflects a temporary tightening of liquidity conditions as GST-related tax payments drained funds from the banking system.

“The short-end part of the curve exhibits stickiness as system liquidity showed some degree of tightness. Going forward, we might see steepness of the yield curve continue unless the war situation resolves and international oil prices show some downward correction,” Dipanwita Mazumdar, Economist at Bank of Baroda, said in a note. The call money rate, which reflects overnight interbank borrowing costs, has also moved up sharply in recent days, indicating tighter availability of funds in the money market. Currently, the liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around Rs 9,289.18 crore as on

July 21, as per RBI data. It has narrowed from a surplus of Rs 69,596.18 crore as on July 20.

So far in July, the systemic liquidity has remained in the narrow range of surplus of Rs 9,289.18 crore to Rs 1.49 lakh crore, as per RBI data.

According to the Bank of Baroda note, average system liquidity surplus inched up to Rs 1.1 lakh crore in July 2026 (first 21-days) compared to Rs 0.8 lakh crore surplus in June 2026. In June 26, liquidity remained considerably tighter primarily due to the seasonal factor of advance tax outflows.

However, RBI's fine-tuning through the LAF window ensured that there is no untoward pressure on liquidity and it remains adequate for effective transmission of credit.

In order to support liquidity, the central bank has conducted various variable rate repo auctions to infuse transient liquidity into the banking system. AGENCIES

Gold rallies to hit 2-wk high of Rs 1.49 lakh/10g

NEW DELHI: Gold prices jumped by Rs 1,900 to a two-week high of Rs 1.49 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Wednesday, tracking robust physical demand and firm trends in global markets.

The yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity appreciated by Rs 1,900 to Rs 1,49,600 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes), according to the All India Sarafa Association.

It had settled at Rs 1,47,700 per 10 grams on Tuesday.

On July 7, gold quoted Rs 1,49,250 per 10 grams in the local market.

Silver rebounded after six consecutive sessions of losses, rising Rs 8,500 to Rs 2,30,000 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes). The white metal had closed at Rs 2,21,500 per kg in the preceding session.

Traders said gold extended its winning run for the third straight session, supported by firm overseas prices, renewed physical demand and



Silver rebounded after 6 consecutive sessions of losses

value buying after last week's correction.

The rally was also supported by value buying and renewed inflows into exchange-traded funds (ETFs), reflecting improving investor sentiment following the recent decline, he added.

Globally, spot gold gained USD 47.43, or 1.16 per cent, to trade at USD 4,125.24 per ounce and silver rose nearly 1 per cent to USD 59.32 per ounce. MPOST

Nippon Life AMC Q1 net profit jumps 27%

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Nippon Life India Asset Management Ltd on Wednesday reported a 27 per cent year-on-year rise in net profit to Rs 504 crore in the June quarter, on higher inflows.

Total income increased 25 per cent to Rs 937 crore, while operating profit rose 31 per cent to Rs 494 crore, it said.

The quarterly average asset under management in the June quarter was up 23 per cent at Rs 7.52 lakh crore (Rs 13 lakh crore). Equity MF average AUM grew 22 per cent y-o-y to Rs 3.51 lakh crore.

The company said that the inflows through systematic transaction increased to Rs 11,030 crore.

Managing Director and CEO Sundeeep Sikka said the company recorded the highest market share gain in the industry during the first quarter of FY27 and continued to witness strong investor trust and steady growth across segments.

‘Recovery of foreign investments shows revival of confidence in Indian economy’

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Indian economy has navigated the external uncertainties well and the recovery of foreign investments in recent months shows a revival of confidence, the Reserve Bank Bulletin said on Wednesday.

The global economy is continuing with the heightened uncertainties emanating from fragile geopolitics and supply chain pressures, said an article published in the July Bulletin of the central bank.

“Amidst these uncertainties, India remains among the fastest growing major economies across the globe and has been able to sustain the momentum in economic activities through June. Both industrial and services sector indicators remained firm,” it said.

The article on the ‘State of the Economy’ also noted that the farm sector is witnessing uneven southwest monsoon, but the impact on food inflation may be mitigated by comfortable foodgrain stocks.



TAKEAWAYS

- » The article also noted that the farm sector is witnessing uneven southwest monsoon, but the impact on food inflation may be mitigated by comfortable foodgrain stocks
- » It further said the momentum of external trade sustained as reflected in high growth in exports & imports in Q1FY27

It further said the momentum of external trade sustained as reflected in high growth in exports and imports in Q1 of 2026-27. This is likely to be strengthened by the recent operationalisation of the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) and progress in other bilateral trade agreements, it added.

“External vulnerability indicators also remained sound. Recovery of foreign investments in recent months shows a revival of confidence in the economy,” the article said.

Foreign portfolio investments saw net inflows in June 2026, driven by policy support

for the debt segment and easing of geopolitical tensions, it said.

In July (up to July 20), FPIs infused USD 3.1 billion into the equity and debt segments.

During April-May 2026, FDI remained higher in both gross and net terms, supported by lower repatriation, it said.

Japan, Singapore and Mauritius accounted for around 74 per cent of the total equity inflows. Financial services received the highest share of equity inflows, followed by manufacturing, retail and wholesale trade, and computer services.

These sectors together accounted for around 80 per

cent of total inflows.

Of the outward FDI, the article said around 74 per cent of the flows were directed towards the US, Cayman Islands, and the Netherlands. The major sectors included financial, insurance & business services and manufacturing, accounting for more than 85 per cent of the outward flows during April-May 2026.

On the price situation, the article said the headline Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation crossed the target for the first time since January 2025, increasing to an 18-month high of 4.4 per cent in June 2026 from 3.9 per cent in May.

GreenLine to power Dabur's green logistics push

MUMBAI: GreenLine Mobility Solutions Ltd, an Essar venture and India's “only” green logistics operator of LNG and electric-powered heavy commercial trucks, has partnered with Dabur India Ltd. to help decarbonise the FMCG major's supply chain through LNG-powered transportation.

Under the agreement, GreenLine will deploy LNG-powered trucks across Dabur India's logistics network to reduce emissions from long-haul freight while maintaining operational efficiency.

The partnership aligns with the growing adoption of lower-emission freight solutions by Indian companies as part of their sustainability goals.

GreenLine Vice President (Sales) Charles Devlin D'Costa said the collaboration reflects increasing industry commitment to cleaner logistics.

Dabur India Global Director-Supply Chain Samrat Sehgal said the partnership will help the company to build a more sustainable and future-ready logistics network. MPOST

Punjab National Bank eyes entry into list of world's top 100 banks

NEW DELHI: State-owned Punjab National Bank (PNB) expects to enter the list of the world's top 100 banks within the next two years, driven by stronger credit growth, improved profitability and expansion into new business segments.

Currently ranked among the world's 125 largest banks by assets, PNB is aiming to join State Bank of India and HDFC Bank as the only Indian lenders in the global top-100 league. In an interview, PNB's Chief Executive Officer Ashok Chandra said that the bank's growth trajectory, profitability and improving asset quality place it in a strong position for higher valuation and sustained expansion. The development comes as India seeks to build larger and stronger banks capable of financing the country's growing infrastructure and industrial requirements.

PNB, which was among the lenders most affected by India's corporate bad-loan crisis in the previous decade, has significantly improved its balance

PNB is currently ranked among the world's 125 largest banks by assets

sheet and shifted focus towards higher-return businesses. The bank reported a more than three-fold jump in net profit to Rs 5,250 crore in the April-June quarter, compared with the corresponding period last year when earnings were impacted by higher provisions.

Its balance sheet expanded nearly 9 per cent year-on-year to Rs 19,90 lakh crore at the end of June. Chandra said he expects the balance sheet to more than double to around Rs 48 lakh crore by 2030, supported by growth in advances and overall asset base.

The lender's improved financial performance and stronger operational metrics are expected to support its ambition of becoming one of the world's largest banking institutions over the coming years. AGENCIES

NEET PROTEST

BOLLYWOOD'S VOICES
OF SOLIDARITY,
SILENCE OF
STARDOM



Khans & Bachchans stay mum as Bollywood's protest chorus gets louder

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The NEET-UG paper leak has sparked nationwide protests, especially after videos of Delhi Police using lathi-charge and tear gas on students during the 'Chalo Sansad' march went viral. In a notable shift from previous nationwide movements, several Bollywood celebrities, such as Ratna Pathak Shah, Seema Pahwa, Mohd Zeeshan Ayyub, Vijay Verma and others, have publicly backed the protesting students.

While Shabana Azmi and Prakash Raj visited Sonam Wangchuk during his hunger strike at Jantar Mantar, celebrities including Anurag Kashyap, Diljit Dosanjh, Imran Khan, Sonu Sood, Vir Das, Dia Mirza, Soha Ali Khan, Aditi Rao Hydari, Rohit Saraf, Aayush Sharma, Riteish and Genelia Deshmukh,

Bhumi Pednekar, Huma Qureshi, Nandita Das, Konkona Sen Sharma, Atul Kulkarni, Sonakshi Sinha, Vishal Dadlani, Pooja Bhatt, Swara Bhasker, Richa Chadha, Soni Razdan, Zeenat Aman and Rajkumar Rao took to social media to support the students and urged the government to initiate a dialogue with the protesters.

Bollywood has often been criticised for staying silent on issues such as the Manipur violence, the wrestlers' protest and the farmers' protest. This time, however, the number of celebrities openly supporting the students has been higher. Even so, some of the industry's biggest names, including Amitabh Bachchan, Shah Rukh Khan, Salman Khan, Aamir Khan (who had earlier distanced himself), Ranveer Singh, Akshay Kumar,

While several celebrities believe they should avoid political commentary, many social media users, particularly Gen Z, argue that screen idols should also speak up on major societal issues

Ran-Kapoor, Alia Bhatt, Deepika Padukone and Katrina Kaif, have remained silent. A section of Katrina Kaif's fans, disappointed by her silence, even announced the closure of a 70,000-plus follower 'Instagram' fan page.

Veteran actor Naseeruddin Shah, whose 'Main Vaapas Aaunga' is currently running in theatres, broke down in a video condemning the police action during the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP)-led 'Chalo Sansad' protest on July 20. The 76-year-old urged students to continue their fight and not lose hope, warning the government: "Sab yaad rakha jayega."

Singer Arijit Singh also condemned the use of force on protesting students. "Har cheez yaad rakha jayega! Yaad rakha (Everything will be remembered. Remember that). The only constant is change," he wrote on social media.

Shabana, who suffered an asthma attack during the CJP protest, recited a powerful couplet by her father, legendary poet Kaifi Azmi, in support of the students.

While Aamir Khan faced backlash from Gen Z after saying '3 Idiots' was not inspired by Sonam Wangchuk, his nephew Imran Khan openly backed the protesters. "I feel like I'm taking crazy pills," he wrote.

Diljit urged the authorities to listen to the students' demands, adding that after the criticism he faced during the farmers' protest, he was prepared for similar backlash again. Comedian Vir Das called on Indian artists not to remain silent spectators.

Among the younger generation of actors, Vedang Raina, recently seen in 'Main Vaapas Aaunga', also voiced his support on Instagram.

"I'm so proud to be part of a generation that cares, that isn't afraid to ask questions, stand up for what it believes in and show up when it matters the most," he wrote.

South, Bengal
Biggies
Remain Silent



While Bollywood's biggest names, including the Khans, Bachchans and Kapoors, have stayed silent on the student protests, South Indian cinema's leading stars such as Rajinikanth, Kamal Haasan, Suriya, Ajith Kumar, Dhanush, Allu Arjun, Jr NTR, Ram Charan and Mohanlal have also not commented publicly.

Prakash Raj is the strongest voice from South India and even visited Jantar Mantar in New Delhi. Director Pa. Ranjith also supported the students. Mohanlal's daughter, Vismaya Mohanlal, however, faced online trolling after expressing support for the students, while Malayalam actor Tovino Thomas voiced solidarity with peaceful protesters and criticised the use of force against them.

In Bengal, film personalities including Aparna Sen, Ritwik Chakraborty, Anjan Dutt, Neel Dutt, Pradipta Bhattacharya, Jeetu Kamal, Sohini Sarkar and Mimi Chakraborty have used social media to back the students.

In contrast, Tollywood's biggest names, Prosenjit Chatterjee, Jeet, Dev, Abir Chatterjee, Rituparna Sengupta, Anirban Bhattacharya and directors Srijit Mukherji, Kaushik Ganguly, Shiboprosad Mukhopadhyay and Gautam Ghose, have remained silent. Many of them had, however, spoken up during the RG Kar rape case protests.

While several celebrities believe they should avoid political commentary, many social media users, particularly Gen Z, argue that screen idols should also speak up on major societal issues.

Kaylee Hottle, deaf 'Godzilla'
actress, killed in car crash at 18

Kaylee Hottle, a deaf actress best known for her starring role in two 'Godzilla' films, died in a car crash in Maryland early Tuesday morning, the Frederick County Sheriff's Office said. She was 18.

Hottle was one of two passengers in the car when it went off the road and hit a culvert in Jfamsville before 3 am. The driver was taken to a local hospital with non-life-threatening injuries and the other passenger declined medical treatment, according to a news release from the sheriff's office. Excessive speed is believed to be a factor in the crash, which is under investigation, the sheriff's office said.

Hottle was a native signer of American Sign Language and her family members are also deaf. Her parents, Joshua and Ketsi Hottle, shared emotional video statements about her death on social media sites. "Kaylee's mom and four siblings are crushed," her father said in ASL in a post from an airport. "They are together at home, grieving. I am on my way to Maryland to bring

She was a native
signer of American
Sign Language

Kaylee's body back home." Hottle's heart stopped before she arrived at a hospital, transported by air from the scene of the accident, her father said. "Very grateful for the 18 years we had together and wish we had more," he said.

In 'Godzilla vs. Kong' and the sequel, 'Godzilla x Kong: The New Empire', Hottle played an orphaned girl named Jia who sees beyond Kong's threatening appearance and forms a special bond with the monster, communicating with him using sign language.

"I'm so devastated to hear this. You will be deeply missed, Kaylee," her 'Godzilla' co-star Millie Bobby Brown posted on 'Instagram'.

Hottle previously appeared in a 2021 television episode of 'Magnum P.I.' She was listed as appearing in the upcoming film 'What Doesn't Kill Us'.

AGENCIES



'My voice misused in Chauhaan'

Mohd Zeeshan Ayyub's voice was 'misused' in the teaser of Ajay Devgn-starrer film

Mohd Zeeshan Ayyub, who said his voice was 'misused' in the teaser of Ajay Devgn-starrer 'Chauhaan', asked the makers to remove the one line he had dubbed for the movie without being given any context.

The actor said he had recorded the lines in 'good faith' as he had worked with the producers in the past, but he wanted to clarify his position as an artist 'who will never be a part of any such project'. The film has generated a lot of criticism online for the way it depicts the unrest in Kashmir and for endorsing the usage of pellet guns.

In a post on 'X', Ayyub wrote: "A few

Ayyub asked the makers to remove the one line he had dubbed for the movie without being given any context

weeks back, a film teaser released with the opening line in my voice. I wish to put on record that I am not part of the film in any capacity. I was asked to dub a line without any reference a few months back. I did that in good faith without asking for more as I knew the makers personally."

The actor didn't name the film or the producers but was referring to 'Color Yellow' as he has worked on their films 'Raanjhanaa' and 'Tanu Weds Manu Returns'.

"As soon as

saw the context in which it was (mis)used, I asked the film-makers to remove my voice from the teaser as I have nothing to do with the film. After my strong objection, the makers removed my voice from the teaser fifteen days ago," he wrote on 'X'.

The actor then drew the attention of his followers to the ongoing student protests in the country. "Our entire attention should be on the present situation of the country where our young relentless students are on the streets putting up a brave fight. Kudos to their inspiring spirit. JAI HIND, JAI SAMVIDHAN," he wrote.

'Chauhaan' is directed by Neeraj Yadav and produced by Jyoti Deshpande, Aanand L Rai and Himanshu Sharma under the banners of 'Jio Studios' and 'Colour Yellow Productions'. PTI

First look:
Gungun Kore Mohua



On the 41st death anniversary of the legendary Bengali actress Mohua Roychowdhury, here's the first look poster of director Rajdeep Ghosh's new Bengali film, 'Gungun Kore Mohua'.

Inspired by the life of the 'Dadar Kirti' actress, the film marks the debut of young Bengali actress Ankita Mullick on the big screen. Ankita was the face of the hit Bengali TV show, 'Jagadhatr' and now she is playing Mohua in the biopic.

'I'll carry forward the legacy'

R Madhavan to host Farooq Shaikh's 'Jeena Isi Ka Naam Hai'

Late actor Farooq Shaikh's 'Jeena Isi Ka Naam Hai' was one of the most popular talk shows in the early 2000s. The show, which used to be telecast on 'Zee TV', would show Bollywood celebrities getting candid about their personal and professional lives.

Now, 'Jeena Isi Ka Naam Hai' is set to make a comeback on the OTT platform 'Zee5', with actor R Madhavan replacing Farooq as the host.

In a statement, Madhavan talked about hosting the show and shared why it is still relevant in the day and age of social media. "Today, we have unprecedented access to the lives of people we admire. We know what they do, where they go and what they share, but we



'Our endeavour is to preserve the soul of the original while making it resonate with today's audiences,' he says

rarely get to know who they truly are. That's what makes

'Jeena Isi Ka Naam Hai' so relevant even today," he said.

The actor added, "The original show, under Farooq Shaikh, created a rare space for honest, deeply human conversations that celebrated the person beyond the public persona. To carry forward a legacy like that is both an honour and a responsibility. As 'Jeena Isi Ka Naam

Hai' returns on 'Zee 5', our endeavour is to preserve the soul of the original while making it resonate with today's audiences."

Madhavan also hinted about the guests the 2.0 version of the show will have. "This season, we'll bring together extraordinary personalities and legends who have taken India to the global stage, while uncovering the defining moments, relationships and untold stories that shaped their journeys because beyond every achievement and every headline is a human story waiting to be told, and those are the stories that truly stay with us," he said.

The release date of 'Jeena Isi Ka Naam Hai 2' hasn't been announced yet. AGENCIES



Ready, Set, Glasgow!

Mirabai and Lovlina lead India's charge as the Commonwealth Games get underway

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: The countdown is over. The 2026 edition of the Commonwealth Games begins on Thursday, with the host city having conceived an energetic opening ceremony in the evening. From an Indian point of view, to watch the athletes walk and showcase India, dressed natively in chic clothes, will be watched with interest. An opening ceremony is more than a formality, it signals how the hosts are prepared.

"Glasgow has worked hard to put on this show. Victoria State in Australia had pulled out last year, so for Glasgow to come forward and accept the Games as hosts needs to be complimented," PT Usha, President, Indian Olympic Association, told **Millennium Post** on Wednesday. Usha is happy she is able to see the Games in a new role, as President. A new high will be two women at the front of the march past who will hold the flag and baton - Mirabai Chenu and Lovlina Borgohain. "These are our best athletes," says Usha.

Once the opening ceremony is over, action begins, from Friday. India are competing in 10 disciplines, Able Bodied plus the Para Athletes. To predict medal tally at this



Finnie, the official mascot for the Commonwealth Games, at the SEC Centre in Glasgow on Wednesday

stage makes no sense. Important disciplines where India won medals in 2022 in Birmingham and have now been removed include badminton and wrestling. So, it all boils down now to medals which can be won in track and field, weightlifting, boxing, mainly. Mirabai Chenu is a big hope in the 48kg section. This is her third shot at gold and glory in the Commonwealth Games. For the diminutive champion, these Games are important, as

India had won 61 medals in 2022 at the last edition of the CWG

well as the Asian Games, to be held in Nagoya, Japan, in September/October. Mirabai has spoken of peaking twice, which will be defining for her.

The boxing star-cast is also rich. Even though Lovlina is the

name most people know, it will be interesting to see how Preti Pawar fares. The 22-year-old from Bhiwani, Haryana, has garnered rich medals in the last three years, including a medal in the last Asian Games and the World Cup. Preti is with the Indian Army, a new first of sorts.

India had won 61 medals in 2022 at the last edition of the CWG. Hazarding a guess, now, will be risky. But then, preparations and inputs have been



Lovlina Borgohain poses after a training session

of the highest order. "I can tell you, after speaking to the athletes and the sports federations, the hard work put in will bear fruit," said Usha.

Glasgow is excited about the Games, even though the programme has shrunk. Volunteers are enthusiastic. Interestingly, many Scots are asking how Amdavad (Ahmedabad) will be as the next host city in 2030. Usha says Amdavad is well-equipped and venues coming up at a fast pace is a positive indicator. "Definitely, there is enthusiasm over the next CWG and we can expect high emotions at the closing ceremony on August 2," added Usha.

'FEAR OF FAILURE HAS NO PLACE IN THIS TEAM'

Shreyas and Co seek to restore pride against Zimbabwe

HARARE: Shreyas Iyer would be eager for his first win as India captain while his young team eyes course correction against a spunky Zimbabwe that is expected to fight hard during the short three-match T20I series starting here on Thursday.

Having lost six out of his first seven T20I games as skipper in series defeats to minnows Ireland and a seasoned England side, the rubber against Zimbabwe gives Iyer and company a chance to get the house in order.

A series win against Zimbabwe would be the expected outcome but a defeat could unsettle the dressing room that also features a 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi.

For this tour, India will have a stop-gap head coach in VVS Laxman, whose personality is diametrically opposite to the combative regular gaffer Gautam Gambhir.

It is not that Laxman wouldn't want to win the series but his propensity to experiment with playing eleven is far less compared to Gambhir.

The spotlight will once again chase 'Boy Wonder' Sooryavanshi, who is set to open in all three games alongside Abhishek Sharma as Sanju Samson hasn't even been



"We don't have to think much about what people are saying outside. We have to stay in the present"

Shreyas Iyer

there were a lot of positives out of that. We got to know what we have to build as a team going forward, what kind of presence of mind, awareness and adaptability we need," Iyer said.

The skipper, who is touring Zimbabwe for the first time, said the biggest challenge would be adjusting to the conditions in a short span of time. "Some of us are playing here for the first time, so the quicker we adapt, the better results we will get," Iyer also urged the young members of the squad to play without the fear of failure despite recent scrutiny following India's performances.

"I don't think they should fear failure because when you have such thoughts at the back of your mind, then you play to save yourself."

AGENCIES

'CAN END FIVE-DECADE WORLD CUP MEDAL DROUGHT'

Harmanpreet hopes for Tokyo encore at WC

NEW DELHI: Indian men's hockey captain Harmanpreet Singh believes his side is capable of ending the country's five-decade-long World Cup medal drought, saying the team heads into next month's showpiece event with the same belief and preparation that helped it end a 41-year Olympics podium wait at the Tokyo Games.

India had snapped a 41-year Olympic medal drought by winning bronze in Tokyo in 2021 before repeating the feat under Harmanpreet's captaincy at the Paris Games. The ace drag-flicker now wants the team to emulate that success at the World Cup, to be held in the Netherlands and Belgium from August 15 to 30.

"We had similar feelings as before the Tokyo Olympics. Our preparation is equally strong because our only goal is to end the 50-year World Cup podium drought," Harman-



India will open their campaign against Wales on August 15

preet said in an interview. "Just as we won an Olympic medal after 41 years in Tokyo, we want to break the World Cup drought as well. We will go with the same mindset and the same preparation. There is no pressure; rather, it is our responsibility."

India's only World Cup triumph came in Kuala Lumpur in 1975. The team had also won bronze in 1971 and silver in

1973 but has not reached the podium since.

For several members of the current squad, including those who were part of India's back-to-back Olympic bronze-medal-winning campaigns, the upcoming World Cup could be their final opportunity to make an impact on the sport's biggest stage. "The team's performance, confidence and unity in recent months have strengthened our belief that this is a golden opportunity," said Harmanpreet, who has played 264 internationals for India. "It is especially important for the experienced players because this could be their last World Cup and there are expectations from them. They want to set an example through their performances."

“

The team's performance, confidence and unity in recent months have strengthened our belief that this is a golden opportunity

Harmanpreet Singh

AGENCIES

It's been a roller-coaster 4 months: Sooryavanshi

HARARE: Indian batting prodigy Vaibhav Sooryavanshi has acknowledged that he has endured "several ups and downs" in the past four months but his confidence remains intact heading into the T20I series against Zimbabwe, beginning here on Thursday.

Riding on his IPL blitzkrieg, the 15-year-old made it to India's T20I tours of Ireland and England. Although he did not feature in the two-match series in Belfast, he made his international debut in the second T20I against England in Manchester, becoming India's youngest-ever international cricketer, eclipsing Sachin Tendulkar's long-standing record.

Sooryavanshi played the next three matches but managed only modest scores and was left out of the fifth and final T20I as Sanju Samson returned to the XI. India went on to lose the series 0-4.

His omission sparked criticism from several former crick-



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi will look to bounce back against Zimbabwe

eters, who questioned the team management's decision to drop the teenage opener after just three innings.

"Yes, there have been several ups and down in the last four months; it's part of cricket it will keep happening but I have to follow the process and give my 100 per cent for the

on and regain his focus.

"It's an obvious thing that whatever I want (guidance etc), the coaches are making it available and whatever practice I require I am getting that. Feeling very good, there is confidence also," he added.

Sooryavanshi was a key member of India's triumphant U-19 World Cup campaign in February, producing a breathtaking 175 off just 80 balls against England in the final at this very venue to power India to the title. "It's a very memorable ground for me. Just four months back, we had played the U-19 World Cup Final and won, so a very special ground. To represent India is everyone's dream and it's a very special moment. I'm playing on a ground where we won the U-19 World Cup four months back and made history (and) to return to the ground and play here will be an altogether different feeling... really enjoying it," he said.

AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Samuel Onyeka, S/o: Onkeya Uba, R/o: H.No. 903, Main Bazar, Mehrauli, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 228/2011, U/s: 420/468/120B/34 IPC, Police Station Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Samuel Onyeka** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Samuel Onyeka** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Samuel Onyeka of Police Station Hari Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains-II
JMFC-11, West, Room No. 31,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9992/WD/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: 5620262027 Dated: 20.07.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-TENDERS on prescribed form for the following work up to 13:30 hrs. on 12.08.2026. The details of the Tender are as under:-

S N	Tender No.	Approx Cost of work (Rs.)	Bid Security
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1	122	18948389.49	379000.00
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Name of work: CTR(P) in loop lines and TFR work in TDL-GZB section under Sr. DENI/IV/PRYJ.

2	123	18950766.88	379000.00
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Name of work: Improvement of Level Crossing Road surface and other connected miscellaneous works in TDL-GZB section under Sr. DENI/IV/PRYJ.

3	124	8023352.96	160500.00
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Name of work: Improvement of level crossing surface by rubber grade crossing system at various level crossing in TDL-GZB section in the Jurisdiction of Sr. DENI/IV/PRYJ.

Completion period: For **SN. 1** - 12 months & **SN. 2 & 3** - 08 Months, **Date of Opening of tender:** For **SN. 1 to 3** - 12.08.2026, **Eligibility Criteria for similar work:** For **SN. 1** - Any P.Way work, **SN. 2** - Any Civil Engineering work & **SN. 3** - Any work involving supply and fixing of rubberized surface on roads or railway level crossing.

(1) E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. (2) The complete information along with tender document of above E-TENDER is available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 12.08.2026. (3) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (4) The tenderers shall submit a copy of certificate as given in tender document in standard format, without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. (5) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of **IREPS** may be approached. (6) The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC April 2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as incomplete offer and accordingly shall not be considered. 1671/26 (PH)

North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Shivam S/o Santosh R/o Near Pappu Property wali Gali, Swaran Park, Nangloi, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 227/2026 u/s 309(4)/309(6)/310(2)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita at P.S. Mundka, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Shivam** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Shivam** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shivam** accused of **FIR No. 227/2026 u/s 309(4)/309(6)/310(2)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita at P.S. Mundka, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **24.08.2026**.

By Order: **Shri Gaurav Singal,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06,
West, Court No. 355,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/10103/OD/2026

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, राँची

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना



नाम-सुरज राँची, उम्र-23 वर्ष, ऊँचाई-5 फीट 6 ईंच, रंग-साँवला, पहनावा-चेक रंग का शर्ट एवं सफेद रंग का जींस पहने हुए है। उपरोक्त लापता व्यक्ति सुरज राँची, उम्र-23 वर्ष, पिता-महेश्वर राँची, साठ-काशमबुरुडीह, थाना-तामड़, जिला-राँची जो दिनांक-10.07.2026 को घर से बगैर बताए कहीं चले गए जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आए है। जिसके संबंध में तमाड़ थाना सन्हा सं-10/2026, दिनांक-13.07.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता व्यक्ति कहीं मिलता / दिखता है तो इसके संबंध में वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।

Email ID(mc-dcb@jhpolicelove.gov.in)

अनु पुलिस पदा, बुलुडू राँची -9431706144

थाना प्रभारी, तमाड़, राँची -9431706993

आवेदक महेश्वर राँची -8987835327

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, राँची

PR 385563 Police(26-27)#D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Akhtar S/o Usman Seikh R/o H.No. 145, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 195/2021, U/S 356/379/411 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Outer North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akhtar** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akhtar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Akhtar** the said accused of **FIR No. 195/2021, U/S 356/379/411 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Outer North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,
(North), Court No.-114, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10080/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

IN THE COURT OF 2ND ADDITIONAL DISTRICT JUDGE JAMMU

File No. : 01/02/2025/Civil Suit
CNR No. JKJM0200014-2025
Date of Instt.: 01.01.2025
Date of Order: 02.05.2026

1. Ajay Sharma S/o, Saran Sharma R/o H.No. 84/5, Nanak Nagar Gandhi Nagar, Jammu
2. Khushal Boli S/o Sh. Mani Sham Boli R/o H.No. 187 Sector 4 Channi Himmat Jammu

(Through: Mr. K.C Sharma Advocate)

1. Rohit Bhadwal S/o Sh. Narinder Singh Bhadwal R/o Ghati Near Nag Mandir Tehsil & District Kathua (Prop. Of Studio 9)
2. Chetna Bhadwal W/o Rohit Bhadwal R/o Ghati Near Nag Mandir Tehsil & District Kathua.

PUBLICATION NOTICE

In the matter of: Notice for the appearance of the defendants in above titled suit.
Coram:

Anoop Kumar Sharma

JO Co.: JK00118

PROCLAMATION

Whereas the Plaintiff has filed above titled suit against the defendants in this court for agreement to sell dated 02.01.2022, whereby the defendant no. 1 has agreed to land sell 135 kanals and 190 kanals under different khasra numbers situated at village Ghati. Distt. Kathua, or for recovery of Rs. 20,00,000/- along with ten times the advance consideration and 18% interest p.a. That this court has issued various summons to the defendants upon given address, but the service of the summons could not be effected for the reason /report that the defendants have left their place of abode, i.e. the address, as is mentioned in the suit.

Therefore this court is satisfied that the service of defendants could not be procured through ordinary manner, so a substituted service under Order V Rule 20 CPC, by issuance of a proclamation to be published in newspaper has been ordered. The defendants named above thus are hereby informed about the institution of this suit and Steeled to appear before this court personally or through an advocate / attorney on 01.07.2026, failing which matter shall be dealt in accordance with law. In case scheduled date of hearing is declared as public holiday, the matter will be taken up on next working day. Given under my hand and seal of this court today on 2nd of May 2026

Sd/-
2nd Additional District Judge Jammu

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-174

Approx Cost	Earnest Money	Date of closing Tender
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21296082.00	425900.00	13.08.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
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Description of work : Virangana Laxmibai Jhansi construction of Soak Pits/Rain Water Harvesting (RWH) arrangements in Jhansi area under ADEN/HQ-II/JHS jurisdiction.

Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 06 Months.

* Tender online can be submitted upto to 15:00 hrs on 13.08.2026. * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1670/26 (D)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

The Dy. Chief Engineer/Const.-I, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi for and on behalf of President of India invites open e-tender under One Packet System for the under noted work:-

Full Name of Work Repair and Renovation of Officer's Rest House at State Entry Road, P. K. Road, Transit accommodation at Chemsford Road, office complex of Dy. CE/C-I/SERD and repairs to staff quarters at Dayabasti, Punjabi Bagh, Chankaya Puri, Thomson Road, Tughlakabad, New Delhi.

Approx. Cost ₹86.91 Lakh (Rs. Eighty Six Lakh Ninety One Thousand only)

Bid Security (Cash/BG) amount ₹1,73,800/- (Rupees One Lakh Seventy Three Thousand Eight Hundred only)

Completion period 18 (Eighteen) months

Sale/availability of tender document on Rly. Website Tender documents will be available on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 21.07.2026 to 12.08.2026 upto 15:00 hrs.

Last date/Time of upload of tenders 12.08.2026 upto 15:00 hours. Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS web site w.e.f. 29.07.2026 to 12.08.2026

Date and Time of opening of tender 12.08.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

No.: 220-Acs-1-1286-ORH-SERD Dated : 21.07.2026 2511/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sunder S/o Late Kanchan Singh R/o D-8, Sharma Colony, Budh Vihar, Ph.-2, Rohini, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 254/2020, U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Budh Vihar, Rohini Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunder** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunder** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Sunder** the said accused of **FIR No. 254/2020, U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Budh Vihar, Rohini Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
North-West, Court No.-112,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9937/RD/2026

(Court Matter)

**AROUND THE WORLD**

» Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's daughter quits Instagram after foreign degree backlash

» IIM Calcutta to prepare management case study on BJP's Bengal poll campaign

» CLAT 2027 to be held on December 6

» IIM Kashipur inducts 24 professionals into Executive MBA Batch 2026-28

**BUZZER ROUND**

Q) WHICH PLAYER WON THE 2026 FIFA WORLD CUP GOLDEN BALL AWARD?

Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our July 16 edition question: **Germany**

Correct answers were sent by: **Arijit Ghosh, Md Uzair, Prashanta Kundu**

**NEWS & VIEWS**

Under the Quadripartite MoU between Région Île-de-France, Choose Paris Region, Avicinity School of AI & Data for Business & Society, France, and IIIT-B, 15 first-year BTech students from the Artificial Intelligence and Data Science course at IIIT-B participated in an international learning immersion programme in Paris.

Researchers from IIT Guwahati, IIM Kashipur, and National University of Singapore have developed a framework that can integrate private transportation services such as autorickshaws, minibuses, and vans into mainstream urban transport. The developed framework focuses on regulating these private transportation systems while addressing existing problems such as road congestion and environmental pollution.

HAS AI BECOME THE SHORTCUT TO CREATIVE WRITING?

AI is changing how essays and novels are written. The bigger question is whether it is changing how people think

URJA SAHA

Let's be honest. Didn't you use ChatGPT or Claude when you were asked to submit an essay in school or college recently? Artificial Intelligence (AI) has become a writing companion for educators, writers and students. AI has rapidly transformed the way people write, research and create content. From generating essays, poems and fiction to drafting emails and presentations within seconds, tools like ChatGPT and Claude have become an integral part of classrooms, workplaces and creative industries. While supporters believe AI is simply another technological advancement that enhances productivity, critics argue that excessive dependence on these tools threatens originality, imagination and language skills.



A POWERFUL TOOL THAT NEEDS BALANCE

There is little doubt that AI has made writing more accessible. Writers can use it to brainstorm ideas, organise outlines, improve grammar, explore different writing styles and even translate content into multiple languages. Students and professionals alike are turning to these tools to save time and increase efficiency.

Many educationists believe AI is an inevitable part of the future but stress that it should complement, not replace, human creativity. Prof Chiranjib Bhattacharjee, Vice-Chancellor of Jadavpur University, Kolkata, believes AI can be immensely useful if used responsibly. "AI is a very important tool but, in terms of creativity and critical thinking, what we need is proper balance. Today, youngsters are using these AI tools to write essays and draft projects. These tools can enhance your writing capability but also restrict your imagination and creativity," he said.

Prof Bhattacharjee further emphasised that while writing effective prompts is an important skill, students must first develop their own writing abilities. According to him, "ChatGPT is a useful tool, but there should be proper guidelines on how to use it and how to control it."

CREATIVITY HAS SHIFTED TO PROMPT ENGINEERING

The rise of generative AI has introduced a new creative skill: prompt engineering. Instead of spending hours crafting every sentence, many users now devote their energy to designing detailed prompts that instruct the AI on what to produce.

Many believe that this represents a new form of creativity. Crafting effective prompts requires clarity, imagination and strategic thinking. The quality of the final output often depends on how well the user communicates their vision. Critics, however, argue that this shifts the creative process away from storytelling itself.

Prof (Dr) Anupam Basu, Vice Chancellor of Sister Nivedita University, Kolkata, compares AI to earlier technological advancements. He believes AI itself is neither creative nor destructive, but simply another tool, much like the transition from pen and paper to laptops and smartphones. "AI can jeopardise the creativity of a person if the mind is jeopardised," he said. According to him, in the age of AI, creativity now lies in designing effective prompts. A meaningful prompt reflects a person's imagination, knowledge and thought process rather than merely being a one-line instruction. However, he cautioned that dependency remains the greatest danger. "The day we stopped writing on paper and started using

laptops or mobiles, our handwriting has been compromised. So, if you would lose your talent," he said.

ORIGINALITY VS AI

The greatest concern surrounding AI-generated writing is originality. Creative writing has traditionally been valued for its unique voice, emotional depth and personal perspective. Writers draw inspiration from lived experiences, relationships and emotions, creating works that reflect individual identity. AI, by contrast, generates text by recognising patterns learned from enormous collections of existing material. While its outputs may appear original, they are ultimately based on statistical predictions rather than genuine imagination or personal experience.

Many students and aspiring writers argue that AI fundamentally conflicts with the purpose of creative writing. Also, The rise of AI writers could lead to fewer opportunities for human creators, especially in fields like copywriting and content generation. In fact, The University of Cambridge stated that a new report involving hundreds of literary creatives from across the UK fiction publishing industry revealed widespread fears over copyright violation, lost income, and the future of the art form, as generative AI tools and LLM-authored books flood the market. Sreemanti Samaddar of St. Xavier's University, Kolkata, believes AI threatens originality itself.

"Creative writing is supposed to be about originality, imagination and the use of an individual's command of language. Not only does AI fail to provide originality, it draws from pre-existing content. Using AI for creative writing is the same as plagiarism, in my opinion," she said.

Similarly, Sreeparna Chakraborty of St. Xavier's University, Kolkata, said dependence on AI gradually weakens creative instincts. According to her, while AI has practical benefits, it diminishes a writer's creative instincts. "Once you start using AI for creative writing, there's no going back. You keep depending on it every time," she explained.

WHEN CONVENIENCE REPLACES CREATIVITY

The speed and convenience of AI are among its greatest strengths and potentially its greatest weaknesses. Tasks that once required hours of research, drafting and revision can now be completed in minutes.

Preksha Prakash of Pune Institute of Business Management believes AI is reducing people's willingness to think for themselves. "People are not able to think originally because they have

become too lazy to think or write by themselves," she said.

Echoing similar concerns, Bipasha Dey of Rabindra Bharati University, Kolkata, observed that earlier, students conducting research or completing projects would consult multiple sources, compare viewpoints and eventually develop their own perspectives. Story writing and other forms of creative work required imagination, emotional investment and considerable effort. She believes instant AI-generated content is making writing increasingly repetitive. "With just a single click, people can generate content instantly. Much of the content being produced is becoming increasingly monotonous and repetitive," she said.

Many students and aspiring writers believe that AI fundamentally conflicts with the purpose of creative writing

DEADLINES REPLACE INSPIRATION

The demands of today's digital content economy have significantly changed the writing profession. Newsrooms, marketing agencies, publishers and online creators are under constant pressure to produce content quickly and consistently. In such environments, AI offers an attractive solution by dramatically reducing writing time.

Beyond creativity, many point to the realities of modern life, where speed often takes priority over artistic expression. Shatadru Pal of St. Xavier's University, Kolkata, believes dependence on AI stems largely from time pressure rather than a lack of ability. According to him, people naturally gravitate towards easier solutions when faced with tight schedules. He believes creativity often suffers under rigid schedules. "The world works on a schedule. And art doesn't like routine. Thus, yes, routine kills art, and creative writing, being a form of art, is affected too," he said.

Bipasha also drew on her experience as a writer, recalling occasions when she was encouraged to use AI to meet tight deadlines. However, she deliberately avoided doing so because she believes machines cannot replicate human empathy, lived experience or emotional depth, qualities that make creative writing authentic.

IIT ROORKEE WARNS AGAINST POLITICAL ACTIVITY WITHOUT PRIOR APPROVAL



OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIT Roorkee has issued an advisory reminding students, faculty members and staff that they should not participate in political movements or make public statements on political issues without obtaining prior permission from the institute.

The advisory, dated July 20, came into the spotlight as student-led protests gathered momentum across the country following demonstrations in Delhi demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over examination-related controversies. After the advisory began circulating on social media, it triggered debate over whether the institute had imposed fresh restrictions on political expression by members of its campus community.

Responding to the controversy, IIT Roorkee clarified that the communication is not a new policy or a recently introduced directive. The institute said such advisories are issued every year at the beginning of the academic session in accordance with its existing conduct rules and should not be interpreted out of context.

According to the advisory, the institute had observed activity on social media platforms, including Instagram and Facebook, where some members of the campus community had allegedly expressed their "affinity" towards "political movement like the one currently" through public statements and criticism.

The advisory reiterates that no student or employee should make any statement or express any opinion in print, electronic or broadcast media that could potentially embarrass the relationship between the institute and the Central government, any organisation or members of the public.

"It has been noticed on social media platforms like Instagram and Facebook that some of the campus inmates have shown their affinity with political movement like the one currently in public utterance and criticism. It is engraved in the notified conduct rules that no student or employee will be allowed to join political discussions or participate in any political activity without permission from the institute or make any statement or any opinion in any media in public utterance which is capable of embarrassing the relations between the institute and Central government or any organisation," the advisory stated.

**ADMISSION ALERT**

OOBT through Mathematics course from IIT Madras Pravartak

Last date to apply is August 6, 2026

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIT Madras Pravartak Technologies Foundation has opened registrations for the latest batch of the 'Out of the Box Thinking' (OOBT) through Mathematics course, an initiative designed to nurture creativity, critical and analytical thinking, and problem-solving skills among school students, college students, educators, working professionals, and lifelong learners.

The OOBT course has been designed and conducted by Sadagopan Rajesh, Mathematics Educator and Founder-Director of Aryabhata Institute of Mathematical Sciences.

The course is available online, completely free of cost and is open to everyone including students, parents and working professionals.

The last date to apply for the next batch is August 6, 2026. The course is scheduled to commence on August 7, 2026.

The OOBT programme consists of four progressive levels, with each level spanning 10 weeks and including periodic assignments and guided solutions. The course is offered by IITM Pravartak Technologies Foundation, a Section 8 company of IIT Madras, funded by the Department of Science and Technology (DST), Government of India.

Learners will also have the option to appear for an in-person proctored examination to be conducted at selected centres across India. Participants can register for the examination by paying a nominal fee. Based on their performance, learners will receive a Grade Certificate issued by IIT Madras Pravartak.

CERN MASTERCLASS 2026

LA MARTINIERE FOR BOYS STUDENTS GAIN EXPOSURE TO ADVANCE SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH

OUR CORRESPONDENT

La Martiniere for Boys, Kolkata, won the Bose Beamline Challenge for Schools 2025 and received the prestigious Visionary Award, marking a significant achievement for the school and its students.

A research paper by Raghav Agarwal, Kabir Agarwal, Yuvraj Shah, Varun Bajoria and Saatvik Gupta, under the guidance of SM Banerjee, earned a team of 12 students an invitation to the CERN Masterclass 2026 in Geneva, Switzerland. The team included Krishav Agarwal, Aarav Kapoor, Yunav Popat, Aarash Neville Koyithara, Samriddha Chakraborty, Stavav Jain and Viraj Saraogi.

During their visit, the students explored CERN's renowned facilities, including the Antimatter Factory and the ATLAS, ALICE and LHCb experiments. They attended lectures



“The success of the students in the Bose Beamline Challenge and the opportunity to participate in the CERN Masterclass 2026 reflect their curiosity, dedication and passion for scientific learning – Sydney Francis Menezes, Principal, La Martiniere for Boys, Kolkata

by leading scientists and analysed real particle physics data, gaining exposure

to advanced scientific research.

The students also visited the United Nations headquarters, Chamonix and Mont Blanc. The experience was an inspiring celebration of scientific achievement, discovery and global learning.

Speaking on the achievement, Sydney Francis Menezes, Principal, La Martiniere for Boys, Kolkata, said, "We are immensely proud of our students for this remarkable achievement. Their success in the Bose Beamline Challenge and the opportunity to participate in the CERN Masterclass 2026 reflect their curiosity, dedication and passion for scientific learning. Experiences such as these give young minds invaluable exposure to the world of advanced research and discovery, and we hope this journey inspires them to continue exploring, questioning and pushing the boundaries of knowledge."

ST. XAVIER'S UNIVERSITY HOSTS INT'L MEET ON DISABILITY RIGHTS & HEALTHCARE

62 research papers submitted from across India

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The Centre for Health Law, Policy and Governance (CHLPG), St. Xavier's University, Kolkata, recently organised a two-day international conference on 'Realising the Right to Health for Persons with Disabilities in India: A Multidisciplinary Perspective on Human Rights, Policy and Economics' in hybrid mode.

The conference was organised in collaboration with the Indian Health Economics and Policy Association (IHEPA) and Manovikas Kendra, Kolkata. Dr Md Zakaria Siddiqui, Associate



Professor of Economics at Jamia Millia Islamia and Vice-President of IHEPA, and Prof Amita Prasad, Director of Manovikas Kendra, Kolkata, were the chief guests. The conference provided a platform not only for academic exchanges but also for policy-oriented discussions on

improved implementation of disability laws, greater investment in accessible healthcare infrastructure and the development of inclusive, rights-based and people-centred health systems in India. "The right to health is not merely a policy aspiration; it is a fundamental human

right and a moral imperative," said Rev Dr Xavier Jayaraj, Registrar, St Xavier's University.

The conference received an overwhelming response, with 62 research papers submitted from across India. After a rigorous screening process, 50 papers were selected, out of which 35 papers were finally registered for presentation. The technical sessions were conducted in both online and offline formats across the two days. A total of 10 distinguished chairpersons and co-chairpersons evaluated the sessions and offered valuable academic guidance to the presenters.